



POSITIVE PARENTING PROGRAMME

FACILITATOR'S GUIDE



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INTRODUCTION

For more than three decades, Cameroon has adopted a national strategy for educating the population about responsible parenthood, following the resolutions adopted by the National Commission on Population at its very first meeting held on November 6, 1985. The Strategy had four components, including family life education. Several actions have been carried out as part of the implementation of the Strategy, including the establishment of a pre-nuptial, marital and parental education programme with a component relating to the promotion and protection of the rights of the child. However, it is clear that despite these multiple actions, the situation of the Cameroonian family has not improved enough. Family conflicts remain recurrent, particularly with regard to relations between parents and children. Parents find it increasingly difficult to educate their children either out of ignorance, or because of their inability to adapt to the perverse effects of modernism, or simply because of their resignation. Children no longer adhere to the parents' directives and easily come into conflict with them, to assert their personality and independence.

The Central African crisis in the Eastern and Adamaoua Regions, the abuses of the Boko Haram sect in the Far North Region and the stalemate of the socio-political crisis in the North-West and

South-West Regions have aggravated this situation. These various crises have accentuated the disorganization of the social fabric, violations of human rights, phenomena such as the abuse of alcohol, drugs and drugs, anger and violence of all kinds, runaways, child marriage, etc. In addition, the dysfunction of basic social services due to insecurity does not always make it possible to provide appropriate responses to the needs of child victims of violence and abuse, who are entitled to holistic care.

In addition, the current COVID-19 health crisis has contributed to an increase in cases of domestic violence and other abuses, especially against women and children, thus increasing their vulnerability. It is therefore important, in order to restore harmony within families and guarantee the full development of children and their full enjoyment of their rights, to strengthen the capacities of parents as well as future parents on the practice of positive parenting, which focuses more specifically on the good management by parents of the difficult situations they often face in the education of their children.

Therefore, the promotion of positive parenting is an opportunity to strengthen the capacities of parents, families and the community in the field of childcare, taking into account their specific needs. It is a question of acting with



these key actors for the protection of the child and the promotion of positive practices of supervision to encourage their full and integral development.

In this perspective, interventions on positive parenting focuses on ensuring that the child can: be protected from violence, exploitation and abuse; enjoy good physical, psychological and mental health to be able to lead a healthy life; explore and develop one's potential for one's adult life; be protected from the vagaries of the economy that may constitute obstacles to the development of its potential; Be positively and satisfactorily involved in family, community and society.

The development of this guide is part

of a dynamic of support for actors in the field in the implementation of capacity building sessions for parents, families and communities for better supervision of their children.



PRESENTATION OF THE FACILITATOR'S GUIDE

Adapted from the Healing Families and Communities programme, the facilitator's guide is a tool for field actors of the public and private sectors (social workers, NGO facilitators, associative structures, etc.), working in the field of child protection or any other area of children's rights, with a view to strengthening their technical and operational skills for the implementation of training sessions on positive parenting. It was designed based on the INSPIRE programme to combat violence against children.

The objectives of the facilitator's guide are to:

- Present the structuring of a training session;
- Promote the use of appropriate andragogical approaches by focusing on participatory techniques such as sharing experiences, role plays and the acquisition of practical skills
- Provide educational tools and facilitation strategies that will assist in the preparation and facilitation of the various training sessions;
- Enable the facilitator to be autonomous in the implementation of capacity building sessions for parents, families and communities.

The facilitator's guide is structured in ten (10) modules subdivided into sessions: **Module 1**, relating to *the perception of the child*, aims to understand the idea that communities have of childhood in order to encourage good practices and possibly raise awareness with a view to a better consideration of the rights of the child. **Module 2**, based on the *role of families and communities in child well-being and*

protection, aims to empower families and communities to better play their roles in child well-being and protection.

Module 3 and 4, dealing respectively with *child development and appropriate parenting practices and the need to invest in the child's human capital from the beginning of their life*, aim to provide parents with knowledge to enable them to know how to talk to their children from birth, show them love and affection, provide them with quality nutrition and health care and finally, show them the need to spend time with them to ensure a good start in life. **Module 5**, on *resource planning and prioritization of the child's needs*, aims to encourage parents to better manage their resources with a priority in meeting the needs of the child.

Module 6, entitled *Taking Care of Yourself to Care for Others*, aims to help parents manage their stress and emotions to better care for others.

Module 7, which deals with *communication with children according to their age*, aims to improve the interaction between parents and children to establish a harmonious relationship in the family.

Module 8, on *positive discipline*, aims to strengthen parents' knowledge of positive child discipline as a method of education based on encouragement and valorization. **Module 9**, on *harmful practices against children* brings out all the harmful practices on children and their effects. **Module 10** entitled *Accompanying your child to better manage the challenges of adolescence*, aims to provide parents with knowledge and skills that can help them better supervise their children in adolescence.



Apart from the introductory and final sessions, the content of each module developed in the guide includes: an introduction, the learning objectives, the methodology, the necessary teaching material/support, the sequential process, the action points/homework to be done, the evaluation of the session, the duration of the session.

For optimal achievement of the objectives of the training on positive parenting, it is important that the facilitator has a good command of the theoretical content of each module and the methodology proposed for the different sessions to be facilitated, before the beginning of the training. This will help to strengthen their capacity to prepare for sessions, organize exchanges, respond appropriately to questions asked by training participants and better guide the group of parents during the learning process.

PRESENTATION OF THE FACILITATOR'S GUIDE

The facilitator in the implementation of the positive parenting program must respect certain principles related to the profession and ethics to carry out his action..

PROFESSIONAL PRINCIPLES

Competencies : The facilitator should be equipped with theoretical and practical knowledge, as well as the necessary tools to establish the positive parenting program.

Effectiveness and efficiency : The facilitator must apply all the theoretical and practical skills acquired in the implementation of the positive paren-

ting program. It must also adopt an appropriate strategy that will allow it to get its message across.

Confidentiality : The facilitator must keep information about the cases followed and only transmit or disclose it at the request of a competent authority.

Empathy : The facilitator must show empathy, while knowing how to observe the right distance to manage his emotions and protect himself.

Obligation to collaborate : The facilitator must have recourse, in the management of the cases followed, to the other actors of the intervention chain according to their nature and specificities.

Accountability : The facilitator is accountable for all actions taken to his/her hierarchy or guardianship.

Decency : As part of the exercise of his activity, the facilitator must always have a decent and correct dress, allowing him to be respected and to respect the cultures and beliefs of the accompanied persons.

Communication, group facilitation and andragogy skills : the facilitator must have full knowledge of community facilitation techniques. In emergency situations or in densely populated communities, it should constitute one or more groups of twenty (20) parents maximum with whom it will carry out in a defined period, one or more modules. He will also have to adapt his approach and language according to his audience.

ETHICAL PRINCIPLES

Respect : the facilitator must accompany the parents he trains, respecting them and their opinions



Honesty : : the facilitator must recognize his limitations and use other skills when needed.

Humility : the facilitator, aware of his limits must adopt a realistic vision of what he can do to better support parents.

Integrity: all facilitators must enjoy moral probity. It must not be influenced by any religious, customary or racist convictions.

Credibility : the facilitator must speak frankly and sincerely and be aware of the role of model he is called to play with the parents he accompanies.

Punctuality and assiduity : the facilitator must respect his appointments, be present at his workstation on time and respect his schedule of activities.

Availability and speed : the facilitator must be available and act diligently when necessary.

In addition to the facilitators who conduct the sessions, at the community and neighbourhood level, it is recommended to rely on community facilitators who will be trained beforehand. These will assist the facilitator in mobilizing participants, conducting home visits and monitoring support groups.



INTRODUCTORY SESSION TO THE POSITIVE PARENTING PROGRAM

« The only way out of violence would be to become aware of the mechanisms of repulsion, exclusion, hatred or contempt in order to reduce them to nothing through an education of the child relayed by all . »

Francoise HERITIER



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Connect with the community and introduce the positive parenting program..

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

1. Bring the parents to know each other and to know the facilitators;
2. Promote the positive parenting program to parents;
3. Discuss program expectations and get parents to register for training sessions;
4. Establish with the participants rules to be respected during the training sessions;
5. Provide participants with an understanding of the basics of positive parenting.

MATERIAL

- ◇ Flipchart ;
- ◇ Markers ;
- ◇ Posters / cards

SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome and presentation of the agenda	10 min	Host
2	Séquence 1 : Presentation of parents and their expectations	15 min	Host
3	Icebreaker : community animation (dancing, singing and encouragement)	05 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Séquence 2 : Presentation of the Positive Parenting Program	15 min	Host
5	Séquence 3 : Setting up group operating rules	10 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Séquence 4 : Forming Parenting Support Groups	15 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Séquence 5: Positive parenting	45 min	Facilitator and participants
8	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Facilitator and participants



INTRODUCTION AND WELCOME

Welcome the parents. Smile and be positive. Praise them for coming. It is not always easy for them to free themselves from their multiple activities

It must be recognized that parenthood is not only hard work, but the most important work in life. We can learn together from our experiences, traditions and science (neurology, psychology).

Note: It is important to recognize that each participant has a lot of knowledge that can benefit the group. As parents, they know their child better than anyone else.

Introduce yourself and share your experiences as trainers or parents (if you are not parents, highlight your experiences as brothers/sisters, uncles/aunts, not being a parent yourself is not a handicap to be a facilitator). Explain why you like the topic of parenting. «The sessions that follow will change our lives, they will help us become great parents!» »



1

PRESENTATION OF PARENTS AND THEIR EXPECTATIONS (15 minutes)

- *Ask parents to introduce themselves, talk about their children, and share with the group their hopes for their children and their expectations for the program. Facilitators should write down parents' hopes and expectations; ideally do it on a board or flipchart, so you write HOPES for their kids and EXPECTATIONS on two flipcharts. In any case, take note of the hopes and expectations of parents because we will come back to them during the last session.*
- *Let parents know that you will keep the flipcharts with hopes and expectations and bring them back on the last day of the program so they can review their first ideas about the program.*

2

PRESENTATION OF THE POSITIVE PARENTING PROGRAM (15 minutes)

Now that the participants know you and each other better, we will present the program and its objectives as well as the methodology that will be used.

WHAT WE'RE GOING TO DO

Explain the purpose of the training sessions and discuss the program sessions with parents.

For example, say:

- We are here to learn from each other. We will share how difficult it is to raise children, but also to improve ourselves and learn techniques to communicate better with our children, to make them better, happier and even more intelligent and sociable. We want children who respect their parents and traditions, who are stronger, smarter and become good citizens.

We want our children to be happy and healthy.

- We will learn from science about the development of children, especially their brains. Some of the data will help us understand why children act the way they do (what we call child psychology), which will allow us to understand them better and also ourselves. Elements of

neurology, psychology, sociology... are part of this training.

- We will study together what is important for young children in terms of nutrition, health, hygiene and protection. We will also discuss together what is important for teenagers, how to address sensitive issues such as sexuality, choosing friends or risky behaviors.

- We will learn the techniques that give us tools and choices in our lives with our children: communication techniques and positive discipline techniques that help children learn to behave well and respect their parents.

- Spending time with children is essential as acting coherently/consistently in raising children. We will ask you to spend time with your children, show them love and practice the techniques we will learn here.



HOW ARE WE GOING TO DO IT?

Outline the methodology that will be used so parents know what to expect. Explain how the sessions will take place, for how long, etc. (Incidentally, this must be discussed with the beneficiaries before the first session to set a suitable day, time and place for the majority).

For example, say:

- It is mandatory to attend all sessions to obtain a certificate of attendance. If you miss a session, you should make up for it through the support of facilitators or members of your Parental Support Group who can come and explain what was said in the missed session.

- We encourage you to come with your partners (husband or wife). Careful! For some projects, it will not always be possible to invite the spouse because we have to keep the group size to 20 participants maximum. In all cases, the participating parent should be encouraged to carry out restitutions at home to ensure consistency and coherence in parenting practices at home. And insist that the training module on positive parenting is not only for mothers, but also for fathers (today we talk more and more about positive masculinity) who are encouraged to come to represent the home.

- We will learn from each other, from our experiences and we will also learn new parenting techniques based on science.

- You will form Parental Support Groups to help each other.

- We will learn through discussions in large groups, small groups or peers, through games, role plays, etc.

We will practice what will be advised and we will have a lot of fun.

- There will be homework assignments at the end of each session, which will be presented at the beginning of each new session.

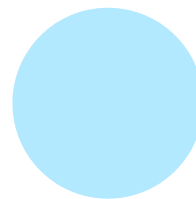
- We will give you flyers during each session, so you remember the key messages. These will help you to take these messages home and to practice them.

- The final session will be a special session, of commitment to a change in parenting practice and will be open to spouses, children and the community.

Note : Each session is based on dialogue and listening, do not hesitate to ask questions, raise concerns, share experiences. Everything you say is important, and it is necessary for parents to respect each other. **CONFIDENTIALITY AND RESPECT ARE MANDATORY.**

Ask parents: Do you have any questions?

Take the time to answer parents' questions before moving on to the next sequence.





3

SETTING UP THE OPERATING RULES OF THE GROUP (10 minutes)

Operating rules (minimum rules): don't use a lot of time on this but keep the flip chart with these rules to guide all participants throughout the module. You will be able to define these rules in a participatory way:

- Punctuality and participation (a certificate will be given at the end only if you have attended all the sessions)
- We respect and pay attention to all members
- Telephone on vibration, etc...

4

SET UP PARENTAL SUPPORT GROUPS (15 minutes)

We want you to setup Parent Groups (Parental Support Groups) of about five (05) parents each, so that in each community you have resource persons, to support each other and to train other parents so that parenting sessions can equally benefit parents who cannot participate in the group. Thus, you will be able to:

- help each other beyond the sessions;
- exchange ideas and feelings with other parents, peers;
- encourage each other to practice the parenting techniques you have learned;
- educate other parents, etc.

Give parents a few minutes to form groups according to affinities, geographical proximity, etc.

5

POSITIVE PARENTING (45 minutes)

« *When I was a kid... »*

Start with an open discussion and ask parents what they consider good parenting. It is argued that as parents (or guardians) we are strongly influenced by the experiences of our own childhood.

Use the flip chart and write:

POSITIVE PARENTING.

Ask parents to recall experiences as children that were enriching and positive for them (you can ask them to close their eyes for two minutes to think about it). Ask parents to talk about their experiences when they were little. What were

their parents' good parenting practices that they remember (we'll try to keep it positive, this is just the beginning)? To increase the list, facilitators can help them by saying :
*«I remember when I was a child...;
 A good memory I have of my childhood ...;
 The feeling I had then was...
 And the feeling that the memory of this beautiful experience gives me is...*



«When I was a child I remember my father taking me to bed in his arms and telling me a story to put me to sleep. I remember the sound of his voice, his breathing and how he gave me a kiss to say goodnight. It makes me smile again and gives me a lot of peace and a little nostalgia...»

What memories do I want my children to have of me in the future?

Now ask parents to form small groups (3 or 4 people). Ask them to answer a simple question: What memories do you want your children to have of you in the future?

Give them a few minutes to complete the sentence: «A good memory I want my children to have of me is...»

Ask volunteers to share their phrases. To save time, ask only one volunteer for each group. These reflections should allow you to talk about positive parenting.

For example, say:

Positive parenting is a philosophy of life. They teach us how to be a good person, a good parent, a good citizen, a beloved friend. On the contrary, neglect, violence and abuse are obstacles to children's growth and development. We need to think and make an effort to become the best parents.

To illustrate the idea of good parenting, facilitators can tell the story of two lions :

A wise old man is teaching his grandson the basic lessons of life and the philosophy of life. The grandfather said to his grandson:

«A fight is going on inside me. It's a terrible fight and he's between two lions. One of the lions is evil, anger, violence, jealousy, sadness, regret, greed, arrogance, self-pity, guilt, neglect, selfishness, resentment, inferiority, aggressiveness, lies, false pride, superiority and ego. The other lion is good - he is joy, peace, love, hope, attention, serenity, tenderness, humility, empathy, respect, forgiveness, family, happiness, gentleness, respect, friendship, growth,

security, dignity, positivity, smile, kindness, caring, understanding and listening, generosity, truth, compassion and faith. But my grandson, the same fight is happening inside your heart where there are two lions fighting a deadly fight.»

The grandson thought for a minute and then asked his grandfather with great concern, «Which lion will win in my heart?» » . .

The wise old man replied simply:
«It's up to you. The one you feed, he will certainly win, but I will help you feed the good lion.»

You can reflect on the story and talk a little bit about these two models of people, two models of parents.



Evaluation of the session

The evaluation is done as part of a small discussion at the end of the session with the group around 4 questions:

1. What did I like most during the session?
2. What question would I have liked to ask but I didn't have the time or the opportunity?
3. What did I learn today?
4. Any other comments or suggestions?

HOMEWORK...

- This week you have two assignments:

1. Meet with your parenting support group
2. You will spend time with your children and you will enjoy the time spent with them. You will feel the joy and happiness of spending time with your children.

Thank parents and praise them for coming and committing to the positive parenting program. Ask each participant to congratulate at least one person. Conclude the session with a song or dance and meet the parents on the day and time indicated.

Don't forget to have the module's attendance list and loyalty check signed.



MODULE 1

THE PERCEPTION OF CHILDHOOD

« Our own values, beliefs and attitudes towards children will influence our ability to recognize risks and concerns and take appropriate action in our child protection policy »

Donald Winnicott



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Encourage families and communities to have a more rewarding and respectful perception of children's rights.

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Identify the different attitudes of the participants towards children and childhood;
- Assess the impact of our values and attitudes on the safety and well-being of our children;
- Help parents and communities to accept their children's disability and provide them with the necessary support;
- Encourage parents to love all their children without discrimination;
- Reaching a consensual definition of the child taking into account national and international texts

METHODOLOGY

The training session is interactive. It will take place in an enclosed or open space depending on local realities. Community leaders (traditional chiefs, religious, community relays...) men, women and children take part in the work.

PREPARATION OF THE TRAINING SESSION

- Information and invitation to participants;
- Consult the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes;
- Preparation of the necessary material (see checklist per session).



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Responsibles
1	Welcome and installation of participants	05 min	Host
2	Evaluation of the previous session's assignment	05 min	Host
3	Presentation of the agenda and objectives	05 min	Host
4	Séquence 1 : Looking back at my own childhood	25 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Séquence 2 : Perception of children and childhood	30 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Icebreaker	05 min	All
7	Séquence 3 : The definition of a child according to the CRC and CADBEE	15 min	Facilitator and participants
8	Séquence 4 : Understanding children with disabilities	25 min	Facilitator and participants



Sequence

1 A LOOK AT MY OWN CHILDHOOD (25min)

Introduce the session with a favorite song / poem / story from your childhood. Briefly talk about why you loved him (memories, bad or good feelings, exciting or comforting, etc.).

Now ask participants to think of a song, poem or childhood story they prefer. Give them a minute or two to think, if necessary. Ask them again to share only the thing they feel comfortable with.

Divide the group of participants into pairs. Ask them to share with their partner. You can use the following questions to guide the discussion :

- What made you think of this poem / story / song?
- Why is this poem / story / song important to you?
- What memories do you have of it?
- Do you associate it with a particular person/time / event?
- What thoughts and feelings do they remind you / her?
- Why is this important when thinking about the children you work with or impact on?

Wait 10 minutes, then bring everyone back into the large group. Each pair is to share with the group the subject of their discussion.

Key learning points

Help participants understand that:

- Whatever is the reason that made us choose this poem / this story / this song, it is important, because it left us

with a lasting memory of childhood.

- Our memories and experiences can influence how we perceive children and childhood.

- Our memories remind us of happy or unhappy moments. For example, stories can be about pleasure, excitement, and evil and danger.

- Understanding children and childhood is key to putting child abuse in context.

- The traditions and rites of our communities have an impact on how children are valued and cared for. Not all children have the same experiences.

- Our own values, beliefs and attitudes towards children will influence our ability to act to protect children.

- The age of the child is a reflection of biological development.



2

PERCEPTION OF CHILDREN AND CHILDHOOD (30 min)

In communities, the child has a recognized value. Some grasp it as a stabilizer of couples/marriages. Others as a wealth, a proof of the value of a woman and even of the whole family. This is the reason why parents are usually identified through their children: one will easily say «the dad of...», the mother of. ..». Thus, any woman or man who escapes these canons is exposed to discrimination and marginalization.

Preparation :

- Take three sheets of conference paper. Write one of the following headings on each sheet:
 - The children of our community today
 - Celebrations of childhood and adolescence
 - Moving from childhood to adulthood.
- Place the leaves on three separate walls.
- Prepare the handout: question cards for each group, so that each group has the same set of questions.

**In your community, what words do adults use to refer to the child? What about when the child has a disability? What does this mean? Does a child with special needs (living with a disability) have the same chances of success as others?*

**What stages of childhood are celebrated in your community? How are they celebrated?*

**When do children become adults? For example, when does the community expect a child to behave like an adult? Are there any ceremonies associated with this change (transition) from child to adult? What are they?*

Process : Introduce the exercise by saying that we will take a close look at the cultural context of children's lives. Explain that we all come from different cultures; Every culture affects our experiences and how we react. This exercise is designed to highlight key cultural issues that we will examine in future sessions.

Divide participants into small groups of three or four people. Give each group the question cards you made. Ask them to discuss each of the questions and agree on 5 answers to put under each of the titles of the flipchart.

Allow 20 minutes for this part of the exercise. Show participants the flip chart on the walls. Ask each group to add their answers under the relevant/appropriate heading:

Discussion (5 min)

Conduct a brief discussion using the following questions :

- What do you notice about the words under each title? Do they reflect negative/positive images? What might this suggest about community/ culture beliefs about children?
- How do the words emphasize children's different experiences, perhaps because of their gender? their physical or mental state?

Icebreaker (5 min)

Say for example: this is a very simple game that will help us introduce ourselves to the group and it will take place as follows :

- The facilitator has a ball in his hand and throws it to another person in the group.
- The person holding the ball intro-



duces themselves by name, where they work, in what position, and something they would like to share about themselves with the group (e.g. their favorite color, favorite food, if they have children, etc.).

- When the person is done, they throw the ball to someone else and the same thing is repeated until everyone has a chance to show up.

3

THE DEFINITION OF A CHILD ACCORDING TO THE CRC AND CADBEE (15 min)

Process : Now that we have discovered how the community defines a child, we will compare this definition with the overall definition of a child under the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC) and the African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child (ACDBEE).

Ask: who knows the CRC? la CADBEE?

Check what participants already know and share the information in the docu-

ment with them.

Specify that according to the CRC and the CADBEE, a child is any person under the age of 18.

Plenary discussion: Start the discussion with participants on why they think the CRC had this definition for the child and to see which definition best suits the Cameroonian context and why..

The CRC and the CADBEE

The United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC) is a legally binding international agreement defining the civil, political, economic, social and cultural rights of every child, regardless of race, religion or ability..

The CRC consists of 54 articles that define children's rights and how governments should work together to make them accessible to all children.

Since the United Nations adopted it in November 1989, 197 countries have acceded to the CRC, while one country in the world has not ratified it. All countries that accede to the CRC are obliged by international law to ensure its implementation. The Committee on the Rights of the Child is responsible for monitoring them.

The Convention requires governments to meet the basic needs of children and help them reach their full potential. Recognition that every child has fundamental rights is at the heart of all this. These include :

- Life, survival and development;
- Protection from violence, abuse or neglect;
- An education that enables children to fulfil their potential;
- Being raised by or having a relationship with their parents;
- Express opinions and be listened to.



In 2000, two optional protocols were added to the CRC. One calls on Governments to ensure that children under the age of 18 were not recruited into their armed forces. The second calls on States to prohibit child prostitution, child pornography and the sale of children in slavery. These have now been ratified by more than 120 States..

A third optional protocol was added in 2011. It allows children whose rights have been violated to complain directly to the UN Committee on the Rights of the Child..

The CRC is also the only international human rights treaty to give non-governmental organizations (NGOs) a direct role in overseeing its implementation, under Article 45a.

The African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child, adopted in Addis Ababa in July 1990, incorporates the provisions of the CRC, the Declaration on the Rights and Welfare of the African Child (July 1979), the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights and the OAU Charter. It takes into account the rights and duties of children based on African socio-cultural realities.

4

UNDERSTANDING CHILDREN WITH DISABILITIES (25 min)

General information on disability

In Cameroon, children living with innate or acquired disabilities are very often discriminated against and stigmatized by their parents, their communities and society as a whole, all overwhelmed and helpless in the face of what they consider witchcraft or the paranormal. These children, who need more attention because of this double vulnerability (childhood and disability), suffer daily from low self-esteem, feelings of inferiority, anxiety, indiscipline and opposition in particular.

Several models can allow us to identify the behavior of others vis-à-vis disability :

- *The charitable model* : : disability was a punishment from God that could only be repaired through charity. This seems to justify almsgiving.

- *The medical model* : Disability is a health condition that is repairable or subject to correction. Rehabilitation

and prescription of equipment result from this approach.

- The social model: Disability is considered to be a disability that stems from society's negative view of the person with a disability. It aims to remove societal barriers that complicate the lives of 'disabled' people. Rehabilitation makes it possible to highlight this vision.

- The rights-based approach : : It guarantees respect for rights and the restoration of dignity. It explains advocacy actions for the equalization of opportunities and equity for better integration/reintegration of people with disabilities.

Things to remember and share with parents

For example: disability is defined as the result of the interaction of two factors: impairment and the various barriers or negative attitudes that prevent the person from participa-



ting in society.

For their development, children living with disabilities have:

- **A need for recognition:** to look at them with a valuing, benevolent and understanding look;
- **A need for prevention,** remediation (rehabilitation of cognitive potentials for greater intellectual efficiency for example) and sometimes care;
- **A need for motivation :** to find accessible answers adapted to their situation.

Mistakes to avoid when caring for children with special needs:

- Keeping them locked up at home;
- Overprotecting them;
- rejecting them or reversing their rank among siblings;
- educating them in a specialized institution (unless medically advised).

What to do:

- let them go out so that they can open up to others;
- take his or her opinion on matters concerning them and the family;
- Go for an inclusive education (in the same institution as able-bodied children unless otherwise advised by specialists);
- encourage their independence.

For example, say : I would like to know if we understood each other.

A child is born with three fingers on each hand/a child is mute, he uses sign language. At the beginning of the school year, he asks you to send him to school. What will your reaction be?

And if you decide to send him to school and he comes back crying and

says, «Mom and dad, I'm not going back to school because I'm being laughed at!» how will you react?

Take a few minutes to listen to participants' experiences of relating and managing children living with disabilities. Commend the parents for their efforts and summarize in a few points the most important elements of the session.

SOME SERVICES AND INSTITUTIONS THAT CAN HELP PARENTS OF CHILDREN LIVING WITH DISABILITIES

Check with parents to see if they are aware of organizations that can help parents with children living with disabilities. If they do not know them you can give them some examples such as: social centers, specialized public institutions, some specialized NGOs, private social works, etc.



EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

The facilitator may, at the end of the session, seek to know through brainstorming if the participants have understood:

- the meaning of the conventional definition of the child;
- the need to have a more empowering perception of all children.

He will also be able to check:

- if the conventional perception of the child seems contrary to or complementary to the perception common to that which the parents have;
- whether parents are willing to revise their perception of children in general and children living with disabilities in particular.

References

- Daniel Goleman, L'Intelligence émotionnelle, Tome 1, Laffont, 1997;
- Donald Winnicott, the child and his family, the first relationships, Payot;
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- Boris Cyrulnik (Collective), your brain has not finished surprising you, Poche 2014 ;
- Françoise Dolto, quand l'enfant semble, Seuil, 1990;
- Alison Gopnik, how babies think, Poche 2016;
- United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child;
- African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child;
- International Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities;
- Law No. 2010/002 of 13 April 2010 protecting the rights of persons with disabilities in Cameroon.



MODULE 2

ROLE OF FAMILIES AND COMMUNITIES IN CHILD WELFARE AND PROTECTION

« It takes an entire village to raise a child. » ».

African proverb



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

To enable families and communities to better play their role in the welfare and protection of children, including in emergency situations

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- To provide families and communities with basic knowledge about child welfare and protection;
- To train families and sensitize communities on their roles in promoting positive parenting;
- To train families and communities how to better manage conflicts related to child development;
- To encourage families and communities on how to care for, treat and value their children's potential and skills;
- Teach families and communities to identify and capitalize on the priority needs of the child.

PREPARATION OF THE SESSION

- Inform and invite participants
- Consult the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes
- Prepare the necessary material (see module checklist)
- Make a brief review of the previous module

NECESSARY EQUIPMENT

- Flip charts and markers
- A4 tip cards and posters
- Image boxes

WORKING METHODOLOGY

- Brainstorming on the definitions of family, community and child, the roles that each entity can play for the common welfare
 - Story telling
 - Role-playing games
 - Group work
 - Sharing of experience.



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

Sequence	Duration	Speakers
Welcome and installation of participants	05 min	Facilitator and participants
Evaluation of the homework of the Module 1	05 min	Animateur et participants
Presentation of the agenda and objectives	05 min	Host
Séquence 1 : Brainstorming with participants	05 min	Host
Séquence 2 : Story. Who is responsible?	20 min	Host
Brise-glace : Role plays	05 min	Facilitator and participants
Séquence 3: Roles and Responsibilities of the family and Community in Child Protection	20 min	Facilitator and participants
Séquence 4: Role plays: de-briefing	45 min	Facilitator and participants
Brise-glace: Community Animation	05 min	Facilitator and participants
Evaluation of the session	05 min	Host
Homework	05 min	Host



Sequence

1 BRAINSTORMING (5 MIN)

- Ask participants how they define the child (check the understanding of the definition given in the last session), the family and the community. Take the point of view of some participants, make a summary and tell the participants that the following sequences will allow them to better understand the theme of the day.

2 STORY TELLING. WHO IS RESPONSIBLE? (20 MINUTES)

“In a distant village lived several communities that practiced agriculture and livestock. Livestock was kept in pens a few kilometres from homes and huge quantities of straw/fodder were collected at the end of the rainy season to feed livestock during long periods of drought. At the same time, farmers used to prepare their fields a little further away from homes and lit fires to burn weeds.

To protect his plantation from devastating fires, it was necessary to put cleanliness all around the plantation and this is what was done by almost all the inhabitants of the village as the sowing approached. Only a few were lazy and refused to bother clearing the edges of their fields arguing that it was their property and that no one should tell them what to do

As time passed, more and more people relaxed in their good resolutions. And the fateful day came. It was a dry morning and the dry, warm wind caressed the few trees that hadn't completely lost their leaves. We saw in the distance a black smoke gushing, it was a bushfire. A farmer sounded the alarm, but only a few farmers whose fields seemed to have been affected felt concerned and began to think about the solution to adopt.

There was a lot of noise but no actions because they did not agree on the approach under the mocking gaze of the few shepherd families present. But the fire continued to advance furiously towards the village. In a few minutes, it set fire on the fodder reserve that was kept at the entrance of the village and continued its progress towards the houses. It was necessary to quickly intervene, but where to start? How do I do this? Who was to participate? Some residents said that it was up to the one who lit the fire to intervene, others thought that only people who had an interest should intervene, but the voice of wisdom was heard fortunately: everyone should act. Each with its own resources and means. Some brought water, others sand, another a saw to cut trees, others gathered young children to evacuate them further etc. Within minutes, the fire was contained and the village saved. Phew! (sigh of relief), they had narrowly avoided the worst. Everyone was happy but beyond the joy, important questions remained: how did we get here? What could have been done to avoid this? How can this kind of incident be prevented in the future? The night promised to be long because everything had to be done so that this did not hap-



pen again!!!”

- After telling this story to the parents, collect their feelings.
- Ask participants to identify key lessons learned.
- Discuss the various questions, including the responsibility of each other in the occurrence of the fire. Emphasize the action of the community as a whole.
- Draw a parallel with child protection. Who is primarily responsible? Who else has a role to play?
- Insist that the protection of the child is the primary responsibility of the parents, of the nuclear family, but it is also the responsibility of the community.

3

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE FAMILY AND COMMUNITY IN CHILD PROTECTION

Divide the participants into 4 groups to work on the role of parents, the role of the family, the role of the community in the protection of children (a group will work on a single category: either the parents, the family, or the community). The fourth group will work on the participation of the child in his protection.

Participants will also be asked the following question: «What are the important techniques for families and communities to better play their role in child well-being and protection?» «

4

ROLE-PLAYING: DEBRIEFING (45MIN)

Organize a debriefing of the work from the previous sessions in a courtroom format. The facilitator informed participants that Group 4, which represents children, would like to know what the role of parents, family and community is in their protection and well-being. The representative of each group comes to explain its role, how to implement it and the commitments made.

The facilitator conducts the session by giving the other members of the group the opportunity to provide additional information, but also to the group representing the children to ask questions of clarification and to make proposals on the points that have not been taken into account.

At the end of the sequence, participants are invited to re-read the different roles (in the form of commitments made for the protection and well-being of children).

Tell parents that sometimes the orien-



tations of the community and the extended family may conflict with the wishes and orientations of parents for the education of children. In this case the parent must consider and retain what is best for his child. This is called the best interests of the child

ACTION POINT / WORK TO DO AT HOME

The facilitator gives participants guidance on the homework:

You will spend time with your children and ask them what a child can expect from their parent. You will also tell them what you expect from your child. We encourage you to spend time and share joy and happiness with your children. Take time to have a frank dialogue with your children.

EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

Have a brief discussion with the group about:

- What did you learn today?
- What did you like most about today's session?
- What did you like the least?
- Is there something you haven't learned or a topic that hasn't been discussed today that you'd like to come back to?

SLOGANS

- «*I am committed to the well-being and protection of the child*»
- «*As a parent, I am committed to respecting children's rights*»

KEY MESSAGES

- Families and communities bear the primary responsibility for protecting children.

- The family and community play an important role in identifying issues and in the design and implementation of child protection activities.

- Family and community involvement will allow interventions to reach more children, as it promotes a more efficient use of resources.

- The active participation of the community in child protection will ensure the sustainability and sustainability of the actions undertaken.

- Strengthening community engagement in the protection and care of their children will support vulnerable children, including in emergencies.

REFERENCES

- 1- CNAPE_RAPPORT_LE CHILD WELFARE OF ENFANCE_NOVEMBRE PROTECTION 2017
- 2- Responsible Kinship Education Program (MINAS), 1988.
- 3- Guide d'éducation prénuptiale, matrimoniale et familiale Tome II (MINPROFF), 2014.



MODULE 3

CHILD DEVELOPMENT AND APPROPRIATE PARENTING PRACTICES

Scientific knowledge about brain development helps us improve parenting practices with young children.

What could be more wonderful than seeing a child, little by little, awaken to life? Witness his first words, his first steps. Seeing him discover the world and opening up to others are moments that we do not forget.



GENERALS OBJECTIVES

Equip participants on parenting practices that promote healthy child development.

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- To teach participants how the brain develops in young children;
- To lead participants to understand the different stages of the child's development;
- To lead participants to understand and apply key concepts for the development of their children;
- To inform the participants of the importance and procedures of obtaining the birth certificate.

WORKING METHODOLOGY

- Presentations
- Questions answers
- Sharing of experiences
- Sharing of experiences
- Encouragement of participants
- Role plays and practical cases.

PREPARATION AND NECESSARY MATERIAL

- Information and invitation to participants
- Consult the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes
- Preparation of the necessary material (color brain images + standard material).



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome and presentation of the agenda	05 min	Host
2	Follow-up of action points from the previous session	05 min	Host
3	Séquence 1 : Discussion on the major stages of child development	25 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Séquence 2 : Discussion around brain images	25 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Icebreaker: Community animation (dancing, singing and encouragement)	03 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Séquence 3 : Birth registration	40 min	Host
7	Evaluation of the session	5 min	Host
8	Homework	05 min	Host

After the welcome remarks, the facilitator will focus on the stages of development of the child, including that of the brain in order to educate participants on the impacts of parenting practices on the harmonious development of the child.



Sequence

1

DISCUSSION ON THE MAJOR STAGES OF CHILD DEVELOPMENT (25 min)

Present the stages of development of children to allow parents to observe them and accompany them for a better development.

Tell parents that there are different levels of child development:

- A psychomotor development: the baby manipulates his toys, his bottle, his own fingers and toes, his mother's breast, learns to discover the world. He needs to suck for food and suck for his pleasure;
- Sensory development: from the first days of life, the newborn begins to discover the world around him, thanks to his senses (taste, touch, sight, hearing and smell);
- Emotional and social development: The baby needs the adult to respond quickly and appropriately to his requests to feel safe. He also needs physical contact, loving words, affection...(if

the facilitator has the ability, he could summarize the study at the basis of Bowlby's attachment theory).

Ask parents to identify children's needs according to age groups through brainstorming. Take a piece of paper or on the board, write down the parents' answers while organizing them. Once this work is done, it is clear of what is expected of parents at each stage of development.

The following table can help you complete or suggest answers to participants.

Table : Stages of Child Development and Appropriate Parenting Practices

Steps	Characteristics	Needs	Appropriate parenting
Pregnancy at birth	Intrauterine development Extreme fragility Beginning of neural connections	Specific diet Affection-love	Acceptance of parenthood Knowledge about the needs of the child in the early years of life Medical follow-up (importance of Pre and post natal Consultation) Good nutrition of the mother Presence of the father



Early childhood 0 - 5 years (0 - 2 years and 3 - 5 years)	Extraordinary brain development Psychomotor development Language acquisition Discovery of the world	Specific diet Strong need for physical presence and attention Beware of safety Need for physical stimulation and appropriate play Need for rules and values	Create an attachment bond with the child through care practices: breastfeeding, play, cuddle Protecting the child through: vaccination, age-appropriate feeding, birth registration
Middle childhood 6 - 11 years	End of infancy and beginning of schooling (which could also be called middle childhood)	Identification to the models (teachers...)	Meeting physical, emotional and psychological needs Teach the child discipline and values Exchange with the child's teachers
Adolescence 12 - 17 years	Puberty Reorganization of identity Relationships Influence of social networks and peers	Autonomy Construction of identity Discovery of limits Peer identification Strengthening the sense of belonging Questioning of values, norms	Affection-love Dialogue-listening Learn about current realities and exchange with your child's associates

Tell parents that each child is unique. Nowadays children are increasingly experiencing early adolescence. So, their parenting practices must adapt to the needs and stage of development of their child. Parents often have children of different ages and their parenting practices should take into account the specific needs of each child.



2

DISCUSSION ON BRAIN IMAGES (25 min)

The aim is to present and explain to parents the need to help children develop their full potential by emphasizing the following points:

- *At birth, a child's brain is not fully developed. The human being is the only specie to be born while his brain is not fully developed. That is why we as parents must help the child complete the development of his brain. 80% of the brain develops in the first three years of life. Much of the structure of the brain is determined for the rest of life during this period, before the age of 3.*
- *The brain is formed by cells called neurons. We have between 80 and 100 billion neurons in our brain. We are a stupendous machine, the most intelligent creature in nature with amazing possibilities to learn, create, discover and love. The brain works through tiny electrical connections that bring neurons into contact. Electrical connections are called synapses. Synapses make this extraordinary machine work.*
- *We turn these cells on and off through experience. We build connections based on our experiences. Not all the cells, the neurons, that we have at birth will be active in our lives. We can activate them through experience, the more we use them, the better they work. As a muscle grows through sports, a neuron grows through brain activity.*
- *Love/affection is to the brain what sport is to the body and muscles. Love helps build synaptic connections. The creation of connections between neurons is done more in the first years of our lives. The more we give our children affection and proper care, the better off they are.*

Love is one of the key ingredients of brain activity like a switch that turns on a light bulb. If we don't treat children properly, if we don't know how to feed them affection and attention, areas of the brain won't develop and some important neurons will die. When these neurons die, a child is not able to learn and develop as well as children who have positive interactions with their parents and those around them.

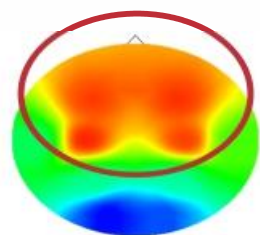
- *Toxic stress caused by abuse and neglect produces chemicals that are harmful to the brain. They kill neurons and synaptic connections. Abuse and neglect inhibit brain development with lifelong consequences for children. A child who benefits from positive parenting practices from his parents or guardians to better brain health, bigger, more active neurons, he will be better prepared to face the difficulties of adult life.*

Show the brain pictures: «Brains can thrive or be underdeveloped based on parental care, love and attention»

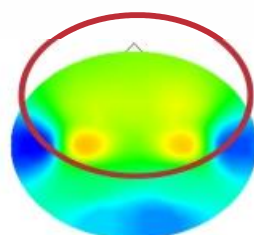
- *Show an image of the brain of a child who has been abused and that of a child who has grown up in a peaceful, protective environment, enjoying the love and attention of his parents.*



Profound Deprivation Affects Bra



Positive Relationships



Extreme Neglect

Source: C.A. Nelson (2008); Marshall, Fox & BEIP (2004).

Ask parents what they see so that ideas come from themselves.

Focus the discussion: You can see how the child in a protective environment has much more electrical activity (red zone) in neurons than an abused child. A brain with a lot of electrical activity is a healthy brain, which creates connections, which develops. Therefore, a brain that has little activity due to abuse or neglect is an underdeveloped brain. Abused and neglected children sometimes have smaller and less active brains, developmental problems (cognitive/intellectual) that affect their life at school, in their community (social/cultural/religious), their personal (emotional/

psychological) and physical (health) lives.

Conclusions we want to draw –

KEY MESSAGE

Parents make the difference: they can make a child reach the maximum of his potential, the smartest, happier, better at school, best friend and family member ... Children need to be loved. Parents have to spend a lot of time with them, love them, talk to them all the time, show them love, attention...

The need for positive and appropriate practices: providing a peaceful protective environment at home/home comes from a reality proven by science. Violence, yelling, body discipline, fights between parents or adults in the house are toxic and prevent the development of the brain and the most complex functions in the frontal cortex of the brain; where we think, solve problems, etc.



3

BIRTH REGISTRATION (25 min)

Brainstorm with participants: ask them what a birth certificate is and what it is used for? What is the procedure for establishing a birth certificate? What are the advantages of having a birth certificate and what are the consequences for a child who does not have a birth certificate?

The facilitator can use the birth registration poster to facilitate the sequence.

Birth registration through the issuance of a birth certificate is often considered the child's first right to have access to a legal identity and to enjoy other rights such as education, health and the right to vote upon reaching the age of majority..

In Cameroon, the registration of births must be made within 90 days after the birth, but parents should not wait for this period to come to an end. They must do this directly after birth.

To register births, parents must go to the registrar. In some villages, there are community-based birth registration mechanisms, in which case the parent must go to the village chief or community protection network who will register his declaration and forward it to the registrar. The parent should inquire about the situation regarding the child's birth certificate. Once it is established, the parent should remove it and keep it safely.

In some hospitals, parents are now able to access the civil registry service on site. These are civil status outposts in health facilities. Parents should therefore inquire if the service is available

in the hospital where the mother attends her antenatal visits or plans to give birth to her baby.

After the period of 90 days to 6 months, another procedure called the state counsel's requisition procedure applies. It is a question of making a request to the State counsel with a file attached composed of the following documents: request of the parent or guardian, birth declaration, certificate of apparent age, photocopies of the CNI of the witnesses / parents, photocopy of the marriage certificate, if the parents are married. It is also important to give reasons why the child's birth certificate has not been issued. The state counsel therefore takes an act authorizing the secretary and the registrar to draw up a birth certificate. .

The auxiliary judgment procedure takes place after 6 months. It is necessary to make a request consisting of a file: non-existence of birth certificate strain, certificate of apparent age issued by a doctor, photocopies of national identity card of witnesses. This procedure is time-consuming and costly.

The facilitator can also open the debate on community and individual solutions to allow each child to have a birth certificate.



KEY MESSAGE

Investing in a child is investing for life

EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

Investing in a child is investing for life

- What did you learn today?
- What did you like most about today's session?
- What did you like most about today's session?
- Is there anything you haven't learned or discussed today that you would have liked to learn or discuss?

HOMEWORK TO DO AT HOME

This week you have several duties:

- Organize age-appropriate games.
- Educate your neighbours about birth registration.
- In your support group, think about what you can do so that all children of group members who do not yet have a birth certificate can have it.



MODULE 4

THE NEED TO INVEST IN THE CHILD'S HUMAN CAPITAL FROM THE BEGINNING OF LIFE (FIRST 1000 DAYS) (1)

Talking with your children from birth, showing them love, affection, providing them with quality nutrition, health care, quality education and ultimately, spending time with them is the key to brain development and ensuring our children get a good start in life.



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Strengthen the capacities of parents/participants over the specific period of the first 1000 days of the child's life and the key aspects taken into account for better care of children.

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Equip participants with knowledge about their role in the child's learning;
- Empower participants on the importance of vaccination and handwashing for disease prevention;
- Equip participants on the importance of a healthy and balanced diet for the proper development of the child.
- Develop participants' skills on water purification and sanitation.

WORKING METHODOLOGY

- Presentations
- Questions and Answers
- Sharing of experiences
- Evaluation of acquired knowledge
- Encouragement of participants
- Role plays and practical cases.

PREPARATION AND MATERIAL'S NEEDED

- Information and invitation to participants/resource person (community health workers, nurse)
 - Consult the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes
 - Preparation of the necessary equipment (nutrition sheet, vaccination booklet, handwashing poster/material, video projector, computer, speaker + standard equipment).



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Leader
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome speech and presentation of the agenda	05 min	Host
2	Follow-up of action points from the previous session	03 min	Host
3	Séquence 1 : What is human capital?	40 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Icebreaker: community animation (dancing, singing and encouragement)	05 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Séquence 2 : Quality nutrition as a safe investment for a child's future life	50 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Homework	05 min	Facilitator and participants



Sequence

1

WHAT IS HUMAN CAPITAL? (40 minutes)

The facilitator is encouraged to read the human capital framework and summarize it to participants according to the literacy level of the participants. If the assembly is composed mainly of participants with low literacy levels, the facilitator can simply tell the story (the Fool/the Wise) and draw the lessons

with the participants. Where conditions permit, he/she can project the video on the Human Capital Index

- YouTube

Human capital could be defined as «the set of knowledge, skills, competences and individual characteristics that facilitate the creation of personal, social and economic well-being». «Human capital is an intangible good that can advance or support productivity, innovation and employability» (OECD, 1998).

Human capital is a key determinant of economic growth. There is now a growing interdisciplinary consensus on the critical role of the early years of childhood in the formation of productive and well-adapted adults.

Policies relating to the family, but also to social assistance and health, seem to have a decisive influence on the acquisition of human capital. Nevertheless, Education remains the linchpin of human capital formation, which puts it at the heart of Academic analyses. But the notion of ‘human capital’ can be extended to ‘informal’ learning and lifelong learning

Investing in human capital to put the vision into action:

«All children achieve their full potential — growing up with healthy diets and readiness to learn, benefiting from school-based learning, and entering the workforce as healthy, skilled and productive adults.»

STORY : The Fool/Wise Man

*DI*n a remote community, hundreds of people lived peacefully with the rhythm of the growing seasons. There was a very remarkable man whom the children called «the madman» because they had forgotten his name and identified him by his very atypical attitude. The «madman» was very jovial, good humoured and very committed to his activities. Indeed, he was a farmer and planted all sorts of crops, especially mango, plum and avocado trees, but no one had ever seen the fruits of his labour. But year after year, this man continued to plant. One day, a young man passing by was curious and intrigued by the name they



gave him: «the madman» and wanted to know more and started to question some people

Young man: What's going on? why do you call him the Madman?

Community: But he's mad.

Young man: Why do you say he's mad?

Community: Just look at what he is doing. Imagine: a man who has been planting for almost 10 years and nothing grows

Young man: Is that why he's mad?

Community: Yes he is because he thinks the tree will grow on its own. He plants the trees anyhow, anytime, anywhere and he imagines that he will have a result. In addition, once he has planted, he does not even bother to go clearing around or watering. That's why we call him «mad.»

Young man: OK, but did you take the time to explain to him what he should do to make it work

Community: but for us it's obvious, does he need us to explain? Everyone knows this

Young man: maybe he doesn't know but we can make up for it by showing him how to do it

Ask participants the following questions :

- What do you think of this story?
- Do you share the opinion of this community when they call this man «mad»? Why?
- What advice would you give him to become «wise»?

Tell participants that as parents, we sometimes behave like the man called the madman in our attitude with our children. Often, we do not provide them with what they need to develop, grow and develop their abilities.

Make a comparison with nature and perennial crops like the saffron or mango tree, before the fruit tree begins to produce, it is necessary to take the time to plant it, water it, give it manure for many years. And when it begins to bear fruit it can last for several decades. The same is true for our children. We must make the right choices, invest in what will allow the child to develop his skills such as education, nutrition, health; accompany and follow him so that the child can develop his full potential and be able to make a contribution in his community and his country. This is how we strengthen the human capital of our children.

Take extra time with participants to discuss how by investing in education and following their children in school, they are building their child's future and the future of the country.

You can leave room for some testimonials or sharing of experiences.



2

QUALITY NUTRITION AS AN INVESTMENT FOR THE FUTURE LIFE OF THE CHILD (50 min)

Tell participants: all parents are concerned about feeding their young child well but do not always have all the information they need to do so. We will learn in this sequence what constitutes a suitable diet in the first 1000 days of life of the child (from conception to 2 years) and how to avoid the harm associated with poor nutrition

11 Perception of food and the impact on the health of mother and baby/young child (15 min)

Explain to parents the following:

All infants and children have the right to good nutrition in accordance with the provisions of the CRC (Articles 6 and 24). Malnutrition among young children has the short-term consequences of morbidity and mortality. Malnutrition is directly or indirectly responsible for many deaths of children under five. Malnutrition (specifically undernutrition) accounts for 45% of the burden of disease in children under 5. More than two-thirds of these deaths are often associated with inappropriate feeding practices and occur within the first year of life.

Only 40% of infants in Cameroon are exclusively breastfed for the first six months, complementary feeding is often started too early or too late, and foods are often nutritionally inadequate and unsafe. Malnourished children who survive are more often sick and suffer lifelong consequences of disrupted development.

The health and nutritional status of the mother are intimately linked to those of her child. Improving infant and young child feeding requires at-

tention first to the health and nutritional status of women at all stages of life, and secondly to the role of women in caring for children and families.

Divide parents into 4 groups to work on the following:

- *What do pregnant women eat in our community? Does it meet the specific nutritional needs of pregnant women? Are there any food prohibitions? Does it affect the nutrition of the pregnant woman?*
- *What do breastfeeding women eat in our community? Is this diet different from that of other household members? Are there any food prohibitions? Does it affect the nutrition of the breastfeeding woman?*
- *What do 0-6 month old babies eat in our community? Does it meet the specific nutritional needs of these babies?*
- *What do children from 06 months to 02 years eat in our community? Is this diet different from that of other household members? Are there any food prohibitions? Does it affect the nutrition of these children?*

• Ask the different groups to present



their work in front of everyone. During the presentations, ask the other participants to complete the proposals of each group and draw a conclusion each time.

1.2 Community nutrition Counselling (20 min)

Tell parents that the next session will allow them to improve the nutrition of babies, young children, pregnant women and breastfeeding women.

The demographic and health survey (2018) reveals that the feeding practice of children under 5 years of age remains inadequate in Cameroon. The rate of exclusive breastfeeding is estimated at only 40%.»

☞ Exclusive breastfeeding

Ask parents what they understand by the term «exclusive breastfeeding.»

Let them talk for 2-3 minutes and also ask them what the benefits of exclusive breastfeeding are. Use the same brainstorming technique and complete participants' responses as needed.

Les avantages du lait maternel pour le bébé

The benefits of breast milk for the baby

Breast milk:

- Saves infants' lives: continuous breastfeeding alone reduces infant mortality by more than 12%;
- is a complete food for the infant and prevents stunted growth;
- is always ready and at the right temperature;
- is easy to digest and nutrients are well absorbed.

The benefits of breastfeeding for the mother

Exclusive breastfeeding:

- prevents new pregnancies during the first 06 months after delivery;
- reduces the mother's workload (she does not have to boil water, fetch fuel, or prepare milk);
- promotes the emotional bond between mother and baby;
- Reduces the risk of breast and ovarian cancer.

☞ The 5 star foods

Discuss with parents the composition of complete meals.

Use the following form:



Order No.	Varieties of food	Examples of local foods	Roles
01	Animal foods	Meat (chicken, fish, liver) Eggs Milk and dairy products	Building foods: these are foods that promote the growth of the individual
02	Staple foods	Flours (maize, wheat, rice, millet and sorghum) Roots and tubers (cassava, potatoes)	Energy foods: these are foods that give strength (energy)
03	Legumes	Beans, lentils, peas, peanuts) and seeds (sesame)	Building foods: these are foods that promote the growth of the individual
04	Fruits and vegetables	Rich in vitamin A (mango, papaya, passion fruit, oranges, dark green leaves, carrots, yellow sweet potato and pumpkin) Other fruits and vegetables (banana, watermelon, avocado, pineapple, tomatoes, eggplant and cabbage)	Protective food: these are foods that protect against diseases and help maintain good health
05	Oil	Palm oil Peanut oil	Energy foods: these are foods that give strength (energy)



1.3 Detecting malnutrition in the community (15 min)

Ask participants *who are most at risk of becoming malnourished?*

Answer: *pregnant women, breastfeeding women and children.*

Ask participants to list the diseases linked to malnutrition.

Answer: kwashiorkor, anemia, skeletal thinness, rickets, blindness etc.

Present the following images to participants and ask them to comment on them

KEY MESSAGES (5mn)

- *a) Mother's, put your babies to the breast immediately after birth even before the placenta is released. You will stimulate milk production, and you give it colostrum which is the first vaccine of the child.*
- *b) For the first 6 months, your baby needs ONLY breast milk even in hot areas, as breast milk is the best food for the baby. It contains everything the baby needs during the first six months.*
- *c) Start giving other foods in addition to breast milk from the 6th month.*
- *d) The best interests of the child is the key to Sustainable Development*



EVALUATION OF THE SEQUENCE

- Use the following table to assess parents' knowledge of nutrition.

Nº	Questions	Yes	No	Don't Know
1	An infant aged 06 to 09 months needs to eat at least 2 times a day in addition to breastfeeding..			
2	A pregnant woman needs to eat 1 more meal than usual per day.			
3	At 04 months, infants need water and other beverages in addition to breast milk.			
4	A woman who is malnourished can still produce enough good quality milk for her baby.			
5	The more a baby heads and pumps milk, the more milk the mother produces..			
6	A newborn should always be given colostrum.			

Homework

This week, parents have two assignments

- 1) In the support group or as a couple, discuss how you want to give your children a good start/invest in their human capital
- 2) With your support group, organize an awareness in your entourage on the benefits of exclusive breastfeeding up to 06 months and 5-star foods.



MODULE 4

THE NEED TO INVEST IN THE CHILD'S HUMAN CAPITAL FROM THE BEGINNING OF LIFE (FIRST 1000 DAYS) (2)

This module is the 2nd part of the previous one. Review the assignments given last week and tell parents that you will talk about child health as one of the 3 pillars to build children's human capital; the other two being education and nutrition.



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome speech and presentation of the agenda	05 min	Host
2	Séquence 1 : Disease Prevention	40 min	Facilitator and participants
3	Icebreaker: community animation (dancing, singing and encouragement)	05 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Séquence 2 : Water purification	30 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Séquence 3 : Malaria prevention	10 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Homework	05 min	Facilitator and participants



Sequence



THE PREVENTION OF DISEASES (40 min)

In addition to quality food and drinking water, three other practices are essential in disease prevention. These include vaccination, handwashing and sanitation.

should children and pregnant women take?

Based on the table below, comment on the different vaccines, at the end of the brainstorming.

VACCINATION

*Brainstorm the following questions:
What is vaccination for? What vaccines*

NB: the vaccination schedule changes according to the years and orientations of the MINSANTE. Please ensure that the calendar you present to participants is updated.



Calendrier de vaccination pour l'enfant de 0 à 11 mois			Calendrier de vaccination pour la femme enceinte		
Contact	Vaccins	Maladies évitées	Dose	Intervalles entre les doses	Durée de protection
A la naissance	• BCG • Polio 0	• Tuberculose • Polio	VAT1/Td1	1 ^{er} contact ou 1 ^{ère} visite prénatale (Dès le début de la grossesse)	0
1 mois 1/2 (6 semaines)	• Polio1 • Penta 1 • Pneumo13.1 • ROTA1	• Polio • Diphtérie, Tétanos, Coqueluche, Haemophilus B, Hépatite B, • Pneumocoque, • Diarrhée à rotavirus	VAT2/Td2	4 semaines après VAT 1	1-3 ans
2 mois 1/2 (10 semaines)	• Polio 2 • Penta 2 • Pneumo13.2 • ROTA2	• Polio • Diphtérie, Tétanos, Coqueluche, Haemophilus B, Hépatite B,	VAT3/Td3	6 mois après VAT 2	5 ans
3 mois 1/2 (14 semaines)	• Polio 3 • Penta 3 • Pneumo13.3 • VPI	• Polio • Diphtérie, Tétanos, Coqueluche, Haemophilus B, Hépatite B,	VAT4/Td4	1 an après VAT 3	10 ans
De 6 à 11 mois 9 mois	• VIT A • RR • VAA	• Rougeole Rubéole • Fièvre jaune	VAT5/Td5	1 an après VAT 4	Toute la vie

HAND WASHING

1. Definition

Handwashing with soap and running water is an essential practice of cleaning hands of all dirt and germs that can lead to illness and harm an individual's health.

Address the following points in the form of a question: How important is hand washing? When should I wash my hands? How should I wash my hands?

2. Importance of hand washing

Handwashing can prevent many diseases in children such as cholera, diarrhea, dysentery, typhoid, polio, trachoma (eye disease). It is also a means of prevention against COVID-19.

3. When should I wash my hands?

- After using latrines or toilets;
- After cleaning the children;
- Before and after meals;
- Before handling food, prepare food.

4. How to wash my hands? Practical example.

The facilitator will demonstrate hand washing, using a plastic kettle, a bucket to collect water and a piece of soap. If you have running water available near where your group is, then use running water. Otherwise bring a bucket with clean water. You will also need a piece of soap. Follow the steps below in the image.



USE AND MAINTENANCE OF LATRINES/TOILETS

1. Correct and Effective use

NB: *human faeces only have a place in the latrine.*

2. Latrine maintenance

A latrine must have a closure (lid) that does not facilitate any exit and entry of flies. It must be systematically closed after use and be swept, washed, weeded regularly. Finally, it must be replaced/emptied when it is full or damaged.

3. Latrine implantation site

It must also be located at least 30 meters from a water source (borehole, well, river ...).

It must have a minimum depth of 2 to 3 meters and not be in contact with water.

4. Qualities of a good latrine

A good latrine must be deep enough depending on the nature of the soil, have a good slab (earth + wood, cement



etc...) to be able to support the user, have a good shelter that allows to isolate the user (doors with bypass, curtain or solid door) to preserve his/her privacy.

A good latrine should have a hand-washing device (kettle, empty box or container plus soap and water or ash) permanently. The latrine must have a closure (lid) that does not facilitate any exit and entry of flies. It must be systematically closed after use and be swept, washed and weeded regularly. Finally, it must be replaced/emptied when it is full or damaged.

HOUSEHOLD WASTE DISPOSAL AND MAINTENANCE OF THE SUR- ROUNDINGS OF THE HOME

Household waste is all waste generated in households, such as food or meal preparation waste, sweepers, household objects, newspapers and miscellaneous paper, small metal packaging, bottles, paper or plastic packaging, rags and other textile residues, etc. It also includes vegetable waste from the maintenance of gardens, yards, etc. Household waste is often also equated with other waste insofar as it is similar in nature to household waste and produced by individuals in relatively similar proportions. Examples include waste from offices, shops, crafts, administrations, halls, fairs, markets, communities such as canteens, maintenance of green spaces and roads as well as all objects and corpses of small animals abandoned on public roads.

The facilitator will brainstorm this issue to draw the attention of participants to the importance of good household waste management for the preservation of the environment. It is also important to insist on the cleanliness of the surroundings of the house



2

WATER PURIFICATION

«Water is life,» they usually say. This expression highlights the value of WATER for all living beings, especially within a community and a family.

Tell participants that using water is good, but drinking water is vital.

1- Definitions : Before making clarifications, go around the table and collect opinions on the meaning of the following words and expressions:

- Portabilization: from the Latin «potabi lis» which means «which can be drunk», drinking water purification is a process that consists in making a thing/element free of any dirt or impurity;
- Drinking water: Drinking water is water that can be drunk or used for domestic and industrial purposes without risk to health.

2- Characteristics of drinking water

Go around the table to gather participants' views on the characteristics of drinking water and make additions in case of non-compliance. Answer: colorless, odorless, tasteless.

3- Sources of Water

Ask parents: what are the different sources they use? Emphasize good water sources and justify. Good water sources include: boreholes, tap (water from water treatment companies), natural springs and deep wells. Indeed, the water from these sources are drinkable because it has either been treated by professionals or has not come into contact with pathogens

and particles.

NB: Draw participants' attention to the condition of the containers with which water is collected in water sources.

4-Processes of water purification

There are several methods of water purification, namely: filtration, boiling, correct use of aquatabs. Take a few extra minutes to discuss each method with the participants.

5-Why make water drinkable?

Answer: to avoid diseases (cholera, typhoid...)



3

THE PREVENTION OF MALARIA (10 min)

Malaria knowledge brainstorming: Ask participants what they know about malaria: how it is transmitted, what are the symptoms, which population groups are most at risk, and how can it be prevented? Make a summary of the participants' different responses based on the following box:

Malaria is the leading cause of morbidity and mortality in Cameroon, Sub-Saharan Africa and worldwide. Indeed, in 2018, malaria represents in health facilities 25.8% of consultations, including 31.5% in children under 5 years of age and 14.3% of deaths, including 28.4% in children under 5 years of age.

Malaria is an infectious parasitic disease caused by a protozoan of the genus *Plasmodium*. This protozoan is transmitted to humans through the bite of a female mosquito of the genus *Anopheles*. Fever is the most common symptom. Pregnant women and children under 5 are most at risk

Malaria prevention is based on two basic principles: protect yourself against mosquito bites and take appropriate preventive treatment without changing the dosage or duration of treatment recommended by your doctor.

WHO recommends the use of long-lasting insecticide-treated nets and indoor spraying to control the number of infected mosquitoes.

Another preventive measure is to give at least two doses of antimalarial drugs during pregnancy to reduce the impact of malaria in pregnant women and newborns.

Take the time to talk to participants about the use of mosquito nets: what

are the benefits of sleeping under the net and what prevents people from sleeping under the net ?

KEY MESSAGES

- Vaccination helps protect children and pregnant women from certain diseases
- Compliance with hygiene and sanitation measures contributes to the preservation of health
- Sleeping under a long-lasting insecticide-treated mosquito net (LLIN) helps prevent malaria.

EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

Have a brief discussion with the group about :

- What did you learn today?
- What did you like most about today's session?
- What did you like the least?
- Is there anything you haven't learned or discussed today that you would have liked to learn or discuss?

HOMEWORK TO DO AT HOME

This week you have several duties:

- Practice hand washing. Provide a container and soap/ash to make hand-washing easier in your household and teach your children how to wash their hands
- Check your child's vaccination record and if any vaccinations are missing, contact the nearest health centre or community health worker
- Organize, alone or with your support group, a human investment session around your home or in your neighbourhood.



MODULE 5

RESOURCE PLANNING AND PRIORITIZATION OF THE CHILD'S NEEDS

*Planning «for others and for oneself allows you to really give
meaning to your life»*

Joel de ROSNAY



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Encourage parents to better manage their resources by taking into account the specific needs of the child.

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Provide parents with basic knowledge of social/family economy;
- Help parents develop and stick to the family budget;
- Help parents identify and prioritize the child's needs in family budgeting.

WORKING METHODOLOGY

- Brainstorming
- Questions and Answers
- Sharing of experiences
- Role-playing games
- Case studies.

PREPARATION OF THE TRAINING SESSION

- Information and invitation of participants
- Invite spouses to participate in this session to facilitate the development of family budgets as a couple
 - Review the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes
 - Prepare the necessary material (see module checklist)
 - Make a brief reminder of the previous module.

Necessary equipment

- ◇ Flip charts and markers
- ◇ Tip cards



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Intervenant/Responsables
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome speech and presentation of the agenda	05 min	Host
2	Séquence 1 : Brainstorming key concepts	10 min	Host
3	Icebreaker: community animation (dancing, singing and encouragement)	05 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Séquence 2 : Development and management of the family budget	35 min	Host
5	Séquence 3 : How to identify and prioritize the needs of the child in the family budget?	35 min	Host
6	Séquence 4 : Sharing experience: Respecting your family budget	20 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Host
8	Homework	05 min	Host



Sequence

1

BRAINSTORMING ON KEY CONCEPTS (10 min)

Engage participants briefly by asking them what they know about the following concepts: family, family budget, money management, sources of income, major expenses, fixed expenses, and variable expenses.

Family : a household comprising at least two persons and consisting either of a couple living within the household, with their child(ren) belonging to the same household; or an adult with their child(ren) belonging to the same household (single-parent family); A set of people united by a kinship or alliance.

Since family sizes, family incomes and lifestyles differ, the proportion of income spent on different needs and wants varies considerably.

Family budget : all the family's resources and expenses. Generally, the family budget is calculated monthly.

Money management: process of planning the use of one's money.

Sources of income for families : salaries, social assistance, interest on savings or investments, gifts and inheritances, products from agriculture, fishing, livestock and handicrafts.

Major expenses of the family: housing, furniture, maintenance and repairs, food, clothing, transportation, education, personal care and health care, taxes, security, gifts, communication credit, water and electricity, recreation...

Fixed expenses: expenses determined in advance and made on a regular basis.

Variable expenses : expenses not fixed in advance that can be adjusted or eliminated during a budget change



2

DEVELOPMENT AND MANAGEMENT OF THE FAMILY BUDGET (35 min)

Parents will learn to make a budget based on their income and expenses.

How to develop a family budget?

In drawing up the family budget, expenses must correspond to income. It should satisfy your needs and take into account your goals.

The steps for preparing and implementing a budget are as follows:

- Estimate your income (if variable, use an average);
- List your expenses (fixed and variable expenses);
- Decide on an amount to save;
- Stick to the budget as closely as possible;
- Record your expenses and compare them with the amounts you had budgeted;
- Make the necessary adjustments, either in the budget or in your expenses, until you get a plan that works for you.

In short, budgets are meant to help you, not to complicate your life. To achieve this, you need to review your budget regularly so that it reflects changes in your expenses and changes in your income. If your budget doesn't suit you, analyze what makes you unhappy and change it. Remember that budgets are plans for future spending and are used to help you achieve your goals.

Practical : Draw the family expense and income tree

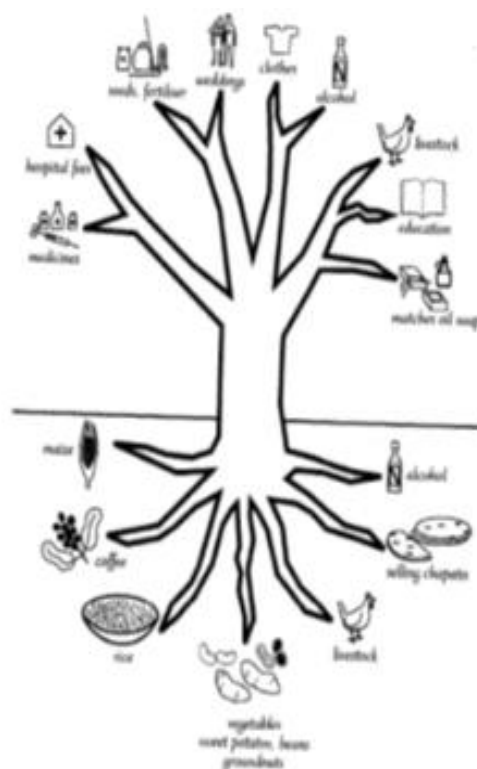
1. Divide participants into groups of 4 or 5 people. Ask the groups to choose one person to play the role of the head of household (male or female), another

person to play the role of husband or wife, and the others to play the role of children.

2. Give each group a flip chart paper.
3. «The Income and Expenditure Tree»

Method :

Draw the tree and explain to the participants that the tree draws the water it needs from the ground through its roots, the water passes through the trunk to the branches to germinate the leaves and possibly the flowers and fruits. Thus, money enters a household and is allocated to a variety of expenses. The trunk can represent the decision-making centre, i.e. where spending decisions are made, ideally the entire family.





Explain that the roots represent household income. Each group must therefore represent (write or draw) at the roots of the tree, the different sources of financial income of their household. We must include the income of adults (this is an opportunity to discuss how to use the income of working children with a precision that we should not support child labour! The child's place is in school)

4. Explain that the branches represent household expenses. Each group must therefore represent at the level of the branches of the tree the different types of expenses (writing or drawing). To define expenditure, it is first neces-

sary to discuss the various expenses in the household and to put on the branches above the most important expenses and on the branches below the least important expenditures. Everyone must agree before drawing on the sheet.

5. Ask one or two groups to present their work. When all the groups have finished, discuss the following questions: Who makes decisions about household spending? Who makes decisions on spending priorities? Do children have the opportunity to express their needs?

3

HOW TO IDENTIFY AND PRIORITIZE THE NEEDS OF THE CHILD IN THE FAMILY BUDGET(35min)

Based on the family budgets that the participants have drawn, examine together whether the needs of the children have been taken into account.

Talk to parents about key expenses for children.

1. What are the big expenses for a child? What are the times of year when more money needs to be found to meet children's needs? How do participants organize themselves to meet the needs of their children?

Comment est-ce que les participants s'organisent pour répondre aux besoins de leurs enfants ?

2. Can we involve children in budget planning? Can they help the family save money?

Make sure the family budget takes into account expenses for children.

1. Ask participants to return to their «family» groups, but this time someone

else must be the head of household.

2. Ask each «family» to revisit their income and expense tree to include expenses for children and to associate income and expenses with an amount to obtain a budget for a family with 5 children for a period of one month or one week. Explain to participants that they should look at each expense in the tree and calculate an amount per week or month that is used for that expense.

3. Ask one or two groups to present their budgets in plenary. Ask the «heads of household» to explain how they prepared this budget.

4. Introduce the three fundamentals of budgeting below (You can also mark them on a flip chart).



FUNDAMENTALS OF BUDGETING

1. A budget should be based on actual expenses and prices.
2. A budget should include all necessary forecasts (weekly and unforeseen expenses/emergencies).
3. A budget must be developed in a participatory manner and take into account the needs of children.

4

SHARING EXPERIENCE ON RESPECTING THE FAMILY BUDGET (20 min)

It is not enough to develop the family budget, but it is important to respect it. This is where the difficulty lies for many parents. The family budget can be affected by unforeseen urgent expenses, lost resources. How can the parent manage these hazards but especially what are the tips?

In small groups or plenary, encourage parents to share tips they've developed over time to stay within their budget. List these tips on a flip chart or on the board to remember.

EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

The evaluation is done as part of a small discussion at the end of the session with the group around 4 questions:

1. What did I like most during the session?
2. What question would I have liked to ask but I didn't have the time or the opportunity?
3. What did I learn today?
4. Any other comments or suggestions?

KEY MESSAGE

1. The well-being and development of the family and children depends on a

good organization of income management.

2. The identification and prioritization of the child's needs contribute to the child's physical, psychological and emotional development.

ACTION POINT / WORK TO DO AT HOME

1. Each partner is encouraged to take time to discuss with their partner and children in order to prepare the family budget.
2. In your support group, discuss the steps to creating a family budget and support each other to help each member of the group set their budget.

REFERENCES

- 1- <https://larbreapalabres.eklablog.com/>
- 2- [https : www.lafinancepourtous.com](https://www.lafinancepourtous.com)
- 3- [https: www.unscn.org](https://www.unscn.org)



MODULE 6

TAKING CARE OF YOURSELF TO TAKE CARE OF OTHERS

*You can also build something beautiful with the stones that
hinder the path*

Goethe



During this session, the facilitator will discuss with participants the psychosocial and emotional needs of parents on the one hand and stress management mechanisms.

GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Help parents learn how to manage their stress and emotions to better care for others.

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Engage parents in identifying their psychosocial and emotional needs;
- Equip parents on the impact of their stress on the well-being of their children;
- Empower parents to identify different stressors in their families and communities;
- Equip parents with stress management techniques (relaxation, physical exercise, etc.) and resilience.

METHODOLOGY

The training session is interactive. It will take place in the enclosed space or open space according to local realities. Community leaders (traditional chiefs, religious, community relays...) .

Pedagogical method: alternating theoretical contributions, exchanges and analysis of practices, scenarios and application exercises to promote stress management.

PREPARATION OF THE TRAINING SESSION

- Information and invitation to participants
- Consult the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes;
- Preparation of the necessary material (standard material + poster on the theme and poster with the different emotions).



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

Nº	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Welcome and installation of participants	05 min	Host
2	Welcome speech	05 min	Host
3	Presentation of the participants	05 min	Participants
4	Presentation of the agenda and objectives	05 min	Host
5	Follow-up of the implementation of the action bridges of the previous-meeting (homework)	05 min	Host
6	SEQUENCE 1 : Identification of parents' psychosocial and emotional needs	40 min	Host
7	Icebreaker		Host
8	SEQUENCE 2 : The impact of parental stress on children	30 min	Host
9	SEQUENCE 3 : Stress Management Techniques	20 min	Facilitator and participants
10	Evaluation of the session	10 min	Facilitator and participants



Welcome and installation of participants

Say: Thank you for accepting our invitation. I am very pleased to welcome you to today's session where we will work on the concept of «*helping ourselves to help others*».

Welcome

Presentation of the agenda and objectives

Say: Today we will be together for 2 hours during which we will explore the following (read the agenda).

This will allow us to achieve the following objectives:

- Identify your psychosocial and emotional needs;
- Gain knowledge about the impact of stress on your children's well-being;
- Learn stress management techniques.

Explain to parents that stress is «an organism total response to environmental demands or pressures.»

1- It is a condition or feeling experienced when a person perceives that the demands exceed his capacity or resources to manage them.

2- It's normal! The body reacts in different ways to cope with high levels of stress.

This may include:

- Changes in behaviour (aggressiveness, confinement, silence);
- Hormonal deficiencies (cessation of menstruation);
- Neurological disorders (muscle weakness, poor coordination, loss of sensation, seizures and confusion);
- All kinds of diseases (eczema, somatic pain, diarrhea).

Ask: Have you ever experienced a similar situation or emotion? (Let the participant share their experience if they wish, but don't spend too much time on negative feelings and experiences.)

Sequence

1

IDENTIFICATION OF PARENTS' PSYCHOSOCIAL AND EMOTIONAL NEEDS (40 min)

Continue the session by telling the parents: we will now do an exercise to identify the emotions felt during unusual situations, our reactions and their consequences. Fill in the first two columns of the table trying to be as honest as possible. Leave the third column for now.



I feel	I do	Consequences

NB: use emotional faces and cartoons in case participants have problems writing.

The participant can choose to combine drawing, collage and writing, as he wishes. You can also do the exercise in plenary, drawing the board on the flip chart. Brainstorm examples with participants and write on the flip chart::

Example :

- o Sadness
- o Illness
- o Aggressiveness
- o Fatigue / exhaustion
- o Anger / hatred
- o Depression
- o Sense of control
- o Happiness.

•

2nd column : *What are the things you do as a result of these feelings? This can be positive or negative.*

Think about examples with participants and write on the flip chart.

Examples :

- *I don't sleep, I don't eat.*
- *I yell at my children, I beat them..*
- *I eat a lot.*

- *I'm obsessed with cleaning.*
- *I have a very clear daily schedule.*
- *I invite the neighbors over for tea to talk.*

3rd column : *Ask parents to think and write down the different consequences of their actions in column 3.*

Give participants 10 minutes to complete their charts

Debrief in plenary. Participants do not need to say what they have written if they do not wish to.

Ask those who were kind enough to participate in the exercise to say how they felt when writing down their feelings.

Example of answers to guide participants (for the facilitator only).

- *I feel (emotions).*
- *I do (if so, what are the changes in your behavior, the things you do or don't do?) this can be positive as well as negative.*
- *Possible consequences for my health / family / children.*



I feel	I do	Consequences for me
Fatigue/exhaustion	I sleep	I don't have the energy to clean up.
Sad	I cry, my children are sad when they see me crying.	I cry, my children are sad when they see me crying.
Sick	I don't eat much.	I am losing weight and feeling weak. I have no energy to take care of my children.
Angry	I don't sleep well, I have nightmares.	I am tired and easily lose my temper on my children.
Adrenaline rush	I have a boost of energy.	I control the situation, I organize my time with great care
Intense joy	I am more sociable, I invite my friends to party, I go out for a beer	It helps me overcome my stress..



2

THE IMPACT OF PARENTAL STRESS ON CHILDREN (30 min)

The Facilitator will explain that:

- Parental stress affects babies and children. When you feel calm, it's more likely that your baby will feel calm. When you feel stressed, it's more likely that your baby will feel tense.
- Research has shown that there are a number of undesirable behaviors associated with parental stress. This means that the more stress parents feel, the worse children behave.
- The worse the children behave, the more stress parents feel. It's like a vicious cycle and perhaps one of the most important reasons for parents to cope and manage their stress.
- Without telling them, they know deep down that their parents are stressed. They also listen to what parents say when they talk to adults. Don't underestimate children's ability to feel tension and understand the current context, even for babies.
- Parents are allowed to feel sad or depressed, but they should try to limit the impact on children.

Ask : How can children be affected by their parents' stress?

Write participants' answers on a flipchart. Responses may include: gressivity, disobedience, fear, refusal to leave the parent, constant crying, etc.

Give participants 10 minutes to fill in the last column of their chart. Similarly, you can use drawings to represent the impact of parental stress on children.



I feel	I do	Consequences for me	Consequences for my children
Fatigue/exhaustion	I sleep	I'm not productive anymore	My children are neglected
Sad	I cry, my children are sad when they see me crying.	I don't have the energy to clean up..	My children are sad
Sick	I don't eat much..	I am losing weight and feeling weak. I have no energy to take care of my children.	My children are neglected
Angry	I don't sleep well, I have nightmares.	I am tired and easily lose my temper on my children.	My children are subjected to my violence
Adrenaline rush	I have a boost of energy	I control the situation, I organize my time with great care	My children feel well surrounded
Intense joy	I am more sociable, I invite my friends to party I go out for a beer	It helps me overcome my stress.	

NOTE TO HOST:

You can use the metaphor of a sponge. «Children are like a sponge, they absorb the emotions and feelings of their parents.»



3

STRESS MANAGEMENT TECHNIQUES (20 min)

The Facilitator may explain that:

- Stress is necessary for life. We need to distinguish between healthy stress that helps us survive as human beings and toxic, repeated or intense stress that overwhelms our systems to the point where it is harmful and becomes a problem for us and those around us, including children. We must be aware of this and deal with it. Stress is only harmful when it becomes overwhelming and interrupts the healthy state of balance your nervous system needs to stay steady.

- When stressors throw your nervous system out of balance, certain techniques can bring it back into a balanced state by producing a relaxation response or a state of deep calm.

it back into a balanced state by producing a relaxation response or a state of deep calm.

Relaxation is a major stress management technique. It is defined as a set of exercises allowing a troubled individual to access a mental and physical state in which he is able to feel relieved of effort or tension. Reaching a relaxed state means controlling our emotions. When stress affects a person's normal functioning, relaxation is necessary to reduce stress levels.

Here are some easy-to-use techniques (write on the flip chart).

For example :

1. Stay away from the stressful event or situation

2. Deep Breath

3. Focus

4. Count from 20 to 0

5. Relax your muscles: visualize every part of your body relaxing, right foot, left foot, right leg, left leg, etc.

Apart from the relaxation techniques to which the participants may be unaccustomed, here are some other tips:

- Eat well, sleep and exercise;
- Take the time to do at least one activity that gives you pleasure every day;
- Take some time to talk to a friend or someone you trust;
- Minimize your use of stimulants: alcohol, drugs, caffeine;
- At the end of each day, try to make a list of things you've helped someone on or things you're grateful for;
- Be realistic about the things you have control over;
- Try a new activity to relax: gardening, sewing, braids, dancing.

NB : the most important thing is to get participants to detect stressful situations and identify some tips that allow them to manage stress. It is also an opportunity to let parents share their different tips and take advantage of this sharing of experience.



KEY MESSAGE

Parental stress has an influence on children's lives.

SESSION EVALUATION (10 min)

Have a brief discussion with the group:

- What did you learn today?
- What did you like most about today's session?
- What did you like the least?
- Is there anything you haven't learned or discussed today that you would have liked to learn or discuss?

Let participants know what to discuss at the next meeting..

Let participants know what to discuss at the next meeting.

Encourage participants to share the knowledge gained with their partners and friends;

HOMEWORK

- In your support groups, discuss the tips you apply for stress management.
- Note your concerns.
- Watch a funny video.
- Turn off your screen for 10 minutes.
- Listen to music.
- Listen to music.

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MODULE 7

COMMUNICATING WITH CHILDREN ACCORDING TO THEIR AGE

Communicating with the child means taking the time to talk with him/her, staying tuned to what he/she is going through and helping him put words on his emotions.



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

To improve the interaction between parents and children to establish a harmonious relationship in the family

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Helping parents understand a child's frustrations
- Helping parents and their children express their emotions in a positive way
- Help parents build trust that allows the child to be open to dialogue
- Give parents tools for effective communication adapted to the stage of development of the child (play ...)

METHODOLOGY

- Presentations
- Discussions
- Group work and practical exercises

PREPARATION OF THE SESSION

- Prepare the tools for good communication
- Make sure that parents are informed of the location of the meeting and that it is prepared
- Reread the 3 key points of the module to better master them
- Review the previous theme and homework

NECESSARY EQUIPMENT

- Flip charts and markers
- Advice cards and A4 posters on communicating with children
- Board games



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Séquence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Introduction of the session	05 min	Host
2	Presentation of the general objective and specific objectives	05 min	Host
3	Séquence 1 : Some principles of communication (the keys to good communication, empathy in communication, the challenges of communication)	20 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Séquence 2 : Communicating with children 0-5 years old	30 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Séquence 3 : Communicating with your adolescent child (Discussion around communication with the adolescent, the challenges of communicating with the adolescent, activities to facilitate communication with adolescents)	30 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Séquence 4 : Playing with your child (Some principles; Practice the game with your child)	20 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Facilitator and participants
8	Homework	05 min	Facilitator and participants



INTRODUCTION OF THE SESSION

- Greetings
- Gather each other's opinions of the past session (review the work to be done at home if necessary), make a reminder of the past session.

Presentation of the topic: We will look at how to communicate with your child. In the course of a day, your child experiences several emotions and can accumulate certain tensions. Since he doesn't always have the words to say how he feels, he needs your help to understand and express what he's going through. When you listen to your little one and put words to how they feel, you help them relieve stress and feel better. He thus develops a sense of security. He feels that what he is experiencing is normal and he gradually learns to better manage his emotions. This is important because it is through communication that you can develop a positive relationship with your child.



1 SOME PRINCIPLES OF COMMUNICATION (20 min)

Engage the discussion with parents by getting them to share their knowledge and experiences about these 3 points: the keys to good communication, empathy and what to do when the child does not speak. The following text can be used as a guide to facilitate discussion with participants.

1.1 *Keys to good communication*

To establish good communication with your child, certain elements are essential.

- Provide a calm and distraction-free environment. Communication with your child will be easier if they feel that you are paying attention. Also limit dual tasks, such as answering your phone or talking to someone else while your child is talking to you. He must feel that he has your full attention.
- Choose a time when your child is available. Your child may not want to talk if they are absorbed in a TV show or game. It is therefore better to wait until another time to discuss with him/her. Mealtime, after prayer, in a common activity (in the field, in the kitchen...) can be good times for discussion, provided that we avoid topics that may disturb the child.
- Keep it brief and clear. Your child will understand the message better if you use a level of language that is appropriate for their development. Choose simple words and short sentences. Avoid long sermons as well. The purpose of the discussion is to have positive exchanges.
- Be attentive to the non-verbal. Through his attitude and gestures, your child sends you messages that can help you better relate to him. Thus, averted glances and a firm position can indicate discomfort in your child.
- Have a respectful attitude. Avoid blaming your child or generalizing by using words like «always» or «never.» For example, phrases «you always forget your book at school» or «you are never happy with the food you are given», «you are always with your friends» can cause a child to close in on himself.
- Be open. If you don't agree with your child, let them know that it's okay to disagree on everything and try to look at things from their point of view. Don't be judgmental. Instead, explain the values that are important in your family and that they must respect.
- Preserve spaces for exchange. In conflict situations, some parents, feeling helpless, tend to avoid talking and run away from the problem. Not reacting immediately can be a good solution.



1.2 Empathy in communication

- Empathy is a person's ability to perceive another person's emotions, needs, and desires. It is the ability of one person to feel what the other person feels.

- For a parent, empathy is the ability to perceive the child's emotions, needs and desires, and be able to respond positively, keeping the child's well-being at the center of the response.

Being empathetic, understanding the feelings and needs of others will help us understand why children behave a certain way and, as a result, parents can communicate in a more constructive and rewarding way.

We will see how to improve your empathy, how to better understand your children's feelings and exchange about it with them. This technique is called «Identifying and Honoring Your Child's Feelings.» It consists of 4 steps:

- Step 1: Identify the sentiment
 - Step 2: Determine the reason
 - Step 3: Honour the feeling
 - Step 4: Help the child express his feelings and act.
- The first step is to try to identify how someone feels. When you have identified the feeling (fear, shame, joy, sadness etc ...) it is good to name it in front of the child. Ask him, «Peter, you're really scared right now, aren't you?» You need to teach your child how he can identify his own feelings and name them, give them a name. Teaching your child emotional language is essential because they need to put into words feelings that are new to them.

- The second step is to understand why Peter feels fear. At this stage, ask, «Why are you so afraid?» Peter will tell you why, if he knows why. Sometimes children have feelings and don't know why (like adults). Honoring their feelings is even more important when children don't know why. For young children, we can try to guess why they have this feeling, but it is better to ask them directly and let them express the causes of this feeling if possible. If this is not possible we can try to find ourselves the reasons for this feeling. For example, if we saw him/her fall down, we can say, «Oh you're sad because you fell.»

- The third step is to honor and respect feelings. If Peter knows why, we must recognize his right to have this feeling because of the circumstances. «Being afraid that there are monsters in the closet is very scary.» Do not reject this reason or minimize it. Recognize and respect the why. If he doesn't know why, honor his confusion. «Being afraid without knowing why, is worrying, I understand.» In both cases, Peter and his feelings were honored.

Talk to parents, and give examples not to follow, when someone is not expressing empathy.

Here are some examples: «Well, that's the stupidest thing I've ever heard – afraid of monsters in the closet!» Or «There's nothing that scares you here. There are no monsters. It's all in your imagination. Stop your nonsense» These two statements belittle the child and despise his feelings, inhibit the child's imagination and expression. If



you put the child down, why do you think he will talk to you again about what he feels?

- The fourth step is to help the child with his feelings. You can reflect with the child on what can help, or if you can do something to help. Sometimes the situation may require the parent and child to think about possible actions to remedy the situation. «We will think about what we can do to help you stop being afraid.» Sometimes the situation doesn't need any action other than just comforting the child or sharing their joy. «Last night you slept alone in your bed and you overcame your fear. You felt really proud, didn't you! »

Organize a role play to practice the four stages of empathy

You will train two parents to do this practice and everyone else will watch it. Tell the parent in the role of child that they will be 8 years old. This child has been arguing with his friend and he feels sad. Then they will work through the 4 steps and if necessary, you can help them with the following script.

First, the parent will help the child identify how they are feeling by saying something like, «oh you look sad.» Then the parent can ask, «What happened?» . The child may say, «I had an argument with my friend and he's not nice.»

The parent then moves on to the third step and says something like, «It doesn't feel good to argue with our friends, I know you must be sad about it.» Then the parent can say to the child, «How do you want me to help you?»

Once you're done, ask the parents in the group to make positive comments

and congratulate them on their efforts.

If there is time left, you can ask the parents to get together and practice the 4 steps (it's better that all participants do the role play).

1.3 Communication challenges

What to do when the child does not speak, when the child is distant and not interested?

- Some children seem to have nothing to talk about. Indeed, even school-aged children have difficulty answering a vague question. Ask open-ended questions instead of yes or no questions. If your child can't remember the day, help them by situating them in time.

- It is also possible that your child cannot find the words to express how they feel. A good way to help him do it differently is to play with him/her. Your child will be able to reveal their concerns in the game.

- Finally, some children refuse contact and are distant. To avoid this kind of situation, be sure to set aside time for your child. Indeed, a child may isolate himself because he fears to disturb a parent who is often absent. Your child knows you're there for them if they see you're available. With all the members of the family, set aside a moment of the evening that everyone will make sure to respect.



2

COMMUNICATING WITH CHILDREN AGED 0-5 (30 min)

2.1 Discussion around communication with children 0-5 years (10 min)

At what age do children begin to understand and is it worth talking with them? How do you communicate with your children? Facilitators can start a dialogue.

Parents need to think again about appropriate expectations.

Crying is an important means of communication. Children communicate differently and we need to adapt, not the other way around.

- You need to talk to your children with the appropriate vocabulary, not too simple (you also need to learn more words) but understandable from birth. Complete sentences, explain to your children what they do not understand: words, feelings, emotions, etc.
- Talk to your child, listen to your child: Children are imaginative and they have their own fantasy world. This is a beautiful part of human development. Many children talk to imaginary friends and believe in things that surprise adults (we adults also have our imaginary world). Don't discourage them, don't ridicule them. Imagination is a fundamental step in the development of the brain and helps to make it stronger; Encourage children to talk to you about anything in their own language, but don't force them. Children have

their own rhythm.

- If you want your child to listen to you or do what you want, you need to talk to the child in a language he or she will understand, and you need to listen to what the child is communicating so that you can understand. Before developing the same language as you (Gbaya, Ffuld , Maka, Bassa, Doula, Ewondo, French, English...), the child has his own language (crying, screaming, smiling, facial mimic, sounds, etc ...)

- You need some basic rules for communication with the child to make it effective, a common language that is sometimes not by words (as in adults):

- o It requires mutual respect !

Ask parents how they perceive communication with their children. Have they ever heard the contemptuous expression «he/she is just a child, it doesn't matter what he says», «don't waste your time explaining anything to a child, he/she is not going to be able to understand anyway» «who cares what he/she thinks»?

- o You need to dedicate time! ! ! You need to spend time communicating, it's a way to bond with your child, nurture love.

How much time do you spend with your children? What do you do when you are with your children? Do they communicate?

- Communication requires information from both sides. It is therefore a dialogue and not a one-way monologue.



2.2 Practice... Role play: I communicate with my baby (20 min)

Ask participants how babies communicate.

Ask participants to say something about each of the following words :

- o Cry
- o Smile (from the second month)
- o Facial sign
- o Movements
- o Laugh
- o Cry
- o Breastfeeding
- o Look into the eye
- o Etc.

- Interaction with babies is essential for brain development. Interactions with parents activate neurons in the brain. This is called «responses and reactions». They help build attachments from birth.

Do the role play with two volunteers and then ask all participants to do the role play for one minute in pairs and swap roles.

Ask the parents to pair each other: one will be the child and the other the parent and vice versa. Invite the parent to do everything the child/baby does, he will copy the baby... This is how we communicate with the baby by paying attention to all the signs of communication that he addresses to us and responding to his signs in the same way to engage in communication.

Organize a game to break the ice.



3

COMMUNICATING WITH YOUR TEENAGE CHILD (30 min)

3.1 Discussion around communication with the adolescent

Review sequences 1.1 on the keys to good communication and 1.3 on the challenges of communication and discuss with parents the important elements to remember to communicate well with children. Emphasize the following:

Have a respectful attitude. *Avoid blaming your child or generalizing by using words like «always» or «never.» For example, phrases «you always forget your book at school» or «you are never happy with the food you are given», «you are always with your friends» can cause a child to close in on himself.*

Be open. . If you don't agree with your child, let them know that it's okay to disagree on everything and try to look at things from their point of view. Don't be judgmental. However, explain the values that are important in your family and that they must respect.

3.2 The challenges of communicating with adolescents

To address the challenges of communicating with the child, you can say: As a child, he told you everything. Now he doesn't tell you anything. When you try to argue, he either responds sharply or triggers an argument that turns your home into a battlefield. Collect the difficulties or challenges parents face and discuss them for a few minutes to develop solutions or strategies

As much as possible, guide, do not impose. The ability to reason abstractly

is like a muscle that needs to be developed. So, when your teenager is faced with a choice, don't do the «exercise» for them. In the conversation, give them the opportunity to find a solution on their own. Then, after discussing different options, you might say, «Think about each of these options for a day or two, and we talk about it together. You can tell me which one you like best and why. »

Share your own experiences. Talking to him/her about what you went through during your own teenage years will make him feel more comfortable talking to you about what he's going through now.

3.3 Good parenting practices to facilitate communication with adolescents

Brainstorm with parents to identify good practices that can facilitate communication with teens:

- *carry out activities with the adolescent (cooking, going to the field, setting traps, playing a board game, playing sports, etc.);*
- *support group between parents;*
- *intergenerational talks (Teenagers/parents) in groups;*
- *adapted games;*
- *be closer to children in general and especially to the girl;*
- *discuss social media use with children;*
- *discuss social media use with children;*
- *conduct educational talks on menstrual hygiene and sexuality*



4

PLAYING WITH YOUR CHILD (20 Minutes)

- Play is necessary and it is an enjoyable experience of parenting. Play and have fun with your kids and spend time with them!
- The game should be age-appropriate and peaceful.
- Children don't try to bore you; They are developing and experimenting, discovering the world around them. Thus, discovery through play is a great way to do it. Have fun with them and you can also rediscover the world around you with them.
- Children need to play alone or with their peers, but they need to play with their parents and parents also need to play with their children, mothers and fathers.

Ask parents about the games they know and the games they play with their children, the games children play with each other... The games they played with their parents. That's wonderful! Imagination, culture, social skills, intellectual development, physical and wearable challenges... are built through the game.

4.1 Broad principles

Play is one of the best ways to communicate with children.

Playing with children requires rules. Which ones? Parents can discuss the rules mentioned in the box below (Where are they?) .

4.2 Playing with your child

Ask for 2 volunteers to do a role play. Role-playing is about playing by respecting all the rules. One is going to be

a parent and the other is going to be a child. Agree on the age of the child (4 or 5 years old for example).

Steps :

- Agree on the game and the age of the child. You can suggest an age and give them a toy to play with (nothing fancy).
- The rest of the participants will observe the game for 2 minutes (no more).
- Analyze what happened. What was good? What would they have done differently? Look mostly at the positives instead of focusing on the negatives.
- Ask for a round of applause and congratulate the parents for the activity, and the participants for observing and giving feedback.
- You can change roles or ask for other volunteers.

EVALUATION (5 min)

The evaluation is done as part of a small end-of-session discussion with the group around 4 questions:

1. What did I like most during the session?
2. What question would I have liked to ask but I didn't have the time or the opportunity?
3. What did I learn today?
4. Any other comments or suggestions?

KEY MESSAGES

- Each child and each adult is unique (outspoken, shy, introverted, dynamic, talkative...)
- We understand and communicate



our perspective based on experience and knowledge. Children have little experience and knowledge, but it should not be underestimated.

- Children are not all that different from adults when it comes to their need to bond and communicate with others. We need to communicate, to tell, to speak.

- Appropriate expectations in terms of communication: You cannot expect a child to respond to his name until he is at least 9 months old, for example. You can't expect a child not to cry (the main means of communication for children), it's like asking an adult not to talk!

- Establishing good communication with your toddler allows you to have a positive relationship with him.

- To promote communication, it is important to take the time to listen to your child, help him put words to what he is experiencing and give him your full attention.

- Talking about topics that interest your child and your day are good ways to encourage them to talk to you.

approach

- Step 1 : Identify the sentiment
- Step 2 : Determine the reason
- Step 3 ; Honoring the feeling
- Step 4 : Help the child express their

feelings.

Take action with your children's feelings, especially if they are particularly sad or upset, very joyful and happy. The feelings are many and can be complex.

We can also follow the 4-step process to understand our own feelings: how do I feel? What for? It doesn't matter, accept that this is how I feel, no matter how logical or inappropriate it is, I feel it. I honor my feelings. And finally, how do you deal with these feelings safely and constructively? What to do? Agree with parents that they will spend time playing with their children, not working, but playing.

HOMEWORK (5 min)

This week you have two assignments::

Assignment 1

1. Talk with your children, regardless of their age! Get to know them!
2. Play with your children! Play well!
3. Talking with your children about sexuality

Assignment 2

This week we're going to try a fantastic new technique, perhaps the most important parenting tool you can learn: empathy. Enjoy the discoveries of your children's feelings. You will try the 4-step



MODULE 8

POSITIVE DISCIPLINE

Children's behaviors are reinforced by positive or negative attention. Positive discipline techniques work best for achieving desired long-term behavior



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Strengthen parents' knowledge of positive child discipline.

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Reduce violence against children as a result of punishment;
- Give parents alternative methods to better discipline children according to their age;
- Give parents alternative methods to better discipline children according to their age;

WORKING METHODOLOGY

- Brainstorming on positive discipline in communities and families
- Questions and answers
- Assessment of acquired knowledge
- Encouragement of participants
- Role plays and practical cases.

PREPARATION OF THE TRAINING SESSION

- Information and invitation to participants
- Audio message for broadcast (community radio and megaphone)

NECESSARY EQUIPEMENT

- ◇ Conference paper, markers, tape
- ◇ Image boxes.



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	SPEAKER / MANAGER
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome speech and presentation of the agenda	10 min	Host
2	Séquence 1 : Science and discipline (what does science say about positive discipline?)	20 min	Host
3	Séquence 2 : Brainstorming on good practices of positive discipline	15 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Icebreaker: community animation (dancing, singing and encouragement)	05 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Séquence 3: Encouragement - Felicitations	20 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Séquence 4 : IGNORE : A Method of Positive Discipline with Young Children	25 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Séquence 5 : Setting up rules	15 min	Host
8	Homework	05 min	Facilitator and participants
9	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Host



Introduction of the session

- Greetings
- Collect each other's opinions for the past session (review the work to be done at home if necessary), make a reminder of the past session.

Présentation of the topic : We will see how children's behaviors can be reinforced by positive attention. Indeed, positive discipline makes it possible to obtain the desired behavior from the child in the long term. In this session, we will see how to get there.

Positive discipline is a method of education based on encouragement and valorization. Also known as caring education, positive discipline provides parents, teachers and educators with a set of tools and a method that is neither permissive nor punitive but collaborative and effective.

Sequence

1 SCIENCE AND DISCIPLINE (20 min)

What does science tell us about discipline ?

- Explain to participants that it is not easy to be a parent, especially if you have a lot of children and not enough means to take care of them. Sometimes we get frustrated when children don't listen to us and when they act in ways we don't like. This frustration is normal. Because, every parent wishes the best for his child.
- Explain that children are not born with a knowledge of the rules of life and must first learn to behave like good little girls and good little boys. They are therefore entitled to mistakes.
« Good discipline does not mean punishment »
- Children need guidance and discipline to navigate life, their communities and society. Parents are there to guide them, to provide them with this necessary socio-cultural framework.
- What is the best way to achieve the desired behaviors of children?
- Children want and need attention, regardless of the behavior: positive or negative. If we pay attention to negative behaviors, the brain will tell our child: just repeat this behavior because mom will pay attention to me. When you hit your child because he/she did something «wrong» (unwanted behavior), you reinforce this «bad» behavior. If you kiss and encourage a child to do something «right» (desired behavior), you reinforce the «good» behavior.
- Ignore unwanted behaviors and positively encourage desired behaviors. These are the two basic positive techniques for good parenting. The majority of other techniques derive from this basis. The child's behavior is always goal-oriented.



Either:

- o attract attention;
- o take power (being in a position of strength);
- o take revenge (make the other suffer);
- o confirm the belief of incapacity (disengage)

2

BRAINSTORMING ON POSITIVE DISCIPLINE TECHNIQUES (15 min)

When you were a child, what methods did your parents use to discipline you? How did you feel after being disciplined? How did you want to be disciplined?

In your community, what are the non-violent methods of discipline that parents use?

3

ENCOURAGEMENT — CONGRATULATIONS (20 min)

- Positive parenting practices are the basis for a good education. Children will be able to repeat the behaviors that are praised. Praise helps build self-confidence, empathy, social interaction, optimism, good conduct, strong relationships with parents, and healthy brain development. Praise and love are the keys to intelligence and development.
- We need to make children understand that their positive behaviour gets a lot of attention from us, that we value it and that we appreciate it. We need to give positive attention to positive behavior

Organize a role play to practice this rule: Praise a child for good behavior

Example : your child is a student in

CE1. You expect him internally to bring you an average greater than or equal to 18/20. At the end of the quarter, he returned with an average of 16. How will you react? Discuss the parents' reaction for a few minutes and propose the following scenario for a role-play:

Say: Congratulations, champion! I know you gave your best. I'm proud of you!

Ask the child: Who was first in the class? What was his average?

Tell him: You can do better than him. He's not smarter than you!

Give him a hug! Or tap him to make him feel that you are proud of him.

Swap a few more minutes to find out how the actors felt. If you have more time, offer another group to practice role-playing. Praise parents for their participation and encourage them to prac-



tice this congratulatory and encouraging exercise with their children.

4

IGNORING: POSITIVE DISCIPLINE METHOD WITH YOUNG CHILDREN (30 min)

We know that children love their parents' attention, whether positive or negative, even if negative attention should be avoided for the proper development of the child. We must make the child understand that when he acts badly, when he behaves badly, we do not agree and that we withdraw our attention. However, this is what he prefers the most in the world! We do this by ignoring negative behavior. Not always easy! But we'll see how to do it.

There are three important steps to ignoring bad behavior:

- Ignore negative behavior. So, if your child starts crying because he/she doesn't want to do his/her homework, don't pay attention to his/her crying. Don't talk to him/her, don't look at him/her, don't smile, don't pay any attention to it nor do anything else, keep busy to help yourself ignore the child's action. For example, you can turn your back and start doing a chore around the house.
- Ignore behavior throughout. Ignoring can be difficult, but you must not give in / let go, you must hold. Children don't like to be ignored, and sometimes, when you start ignoring them, they will act even more. They will try different things to see if they can get your attention. For example, they might start crying or screaming even louder.

Be sure to keep calm by ignoring negative behaviors. You can't start ignoring, and then give your full attention when your child starts screaming louder. This will teach him to attract your attention through even more negative behavior. So hold on! And you will see it is your child who will get tired and eventually stop.

- Praise your child once they stop the negative behavior: «I really like it when you're quiet» or «Thank you for calming down; You show me that you are reasonable that you know how to control your emotions and negative feelings. You have to be brave and mature to do something like that. I am proud of you my child. ». This will teach your child that negative behavior does not receive attention, but positive behavior does.

Organize a role play to practice: Ignoring a child who is behaving badly



5

SETTING UP RULES (15 minutes)

The three key tips for implementing rules are:

- Establish clear boundaries for your child's behaviour. Sit down with the family and discuss the rules to follow in the house. Explain to children the consequences if they do not follow these rules.
- If your child is doing something wrong, stay calm and give them clear instructions to stop the bad behavior and do something you want them to do, i.e. «Stop breaking things in the house, go get water.» Praise your child if they stop the bad behavior. If he does not stop, one must follow with the appropriate consequence.
- Have realistic expectations. All children and adults do bad things from time to time.

Practice: setting up rules

1. Read the three «Key Tips for Parents» above. Discuss with participants these three tips.
2. Ask participants to get back into groups of 3-4 people and reflect on the house rules, as well as the appropriate consequences if children do not follow these rules.
3. Ask each group to share their family rules and consequences. Discuss the different rules proposed. Are the rules appropriate for small children and adults?

Discuss the proposed consequences.

EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

1. Name 3 alternative methods for your child's positive discipline.
2. Name 4 negative consequences of the punitive sanction on your child.

ACTION POINT / WORK TO DO AT HOME

This week you have several duties:

1. Praise your children for good behavior.
2. Do not hit your children, as we have seen it is useless to stop bad behavior.
3. Ignore your children's bad behavior.
4. Set up rules at home.

KEYS MESSAGES

1. Parents should differentiate the types of positive discipline to give their child according to age.
2. Punitive sanctions have an impact on the physical, psychological and emotional development of the child.
3. Communication and counselling contribute to the positive discipline of children.
4. Deprivation of children's rights cannot be an alternative form of positive discipline



MODULE 9

HARMFUL PRACTICES AGAINST CHILDREN



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Support participants to identify and address harmful practices that affect children in their community especially child marriage

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Equip parents with the necessary skills to identify harmful practices and understand the consequences of these practices in the lives of children and adolescents;
- Help parents develop actions to prevent or combat harmful traditional practices.

WORKING METHODOLOGY

- Presentations
- Questions and answers
- Sharing of experiences
- Case studies
- Evaluation of acquired knowledge.

PREPARATION OF THE SESSION

- Invite parents involved in the program
- Review the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes
- Prepare the necessary material (see module checklist).

EQUIPMENT REQUIRED

- ◇ Flip charts and markers
- ◇ Scale with two trays
- ◇ Pulling rope
- ◇ Pamphlets



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Welcome and installation of participants	05 min	host
2	Welcome speech and presentation of the agenda	05 min	host
3	Séquence 1 : Brainstorming on harmful practices that affect children in our community	15 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Séquence 2 : Child marriage	40 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Icebreaker	05 min	Facilitator and participants
6	Séquence 3 : Balancing the pros and cons of practicing child marriage with action points for the future	30 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Facilitator and participants
8	Homework	05 min	Host



INTRODUCTION OF THE SESSION

Tell parents that today you will be discussing harmful traditional practices that affect the well-being of children and youth in the community. These are practices that are culturally accepted as good, but have a negative effect on the physical, psychological and emotional development of children and adolescents.

Are you familiar with any of these practices?



Sequence

1

BRAINSTORMING ON HARMFUL PRACTICES AFFECTING CHILDREN IN OUR COMMUNITY

Give parents about ten minutes to share their ideas about harmful traditional practices and how they affect children and adolescents in the community.

Parents could mention discrimination between boys and girls, violence such as beating, sexual exploitation/sex for survival, female genital mutilation (cutting), child marriage, etc.

Tell parents: we will discuss in depth about one harmful traditional practice in particular. Try to make them guess.

2

CHILD MARRIAGE

Take a few minutes to define what child marriage is by involving parents.

Child marriage is any formal marriage or informal union between a child under the age of 18 and an adult or another child. Child marriage affects both boys and girls, but it affects girls more. Worldwide, one in four girls were married before reaching adulthood ten years ago, compared to about one in five today. In Cameroon, data from the Demographic and Health Survey (DHS, 2018) indicate that the prevention rate of child marriage is 29.8%.

The regions of north, Adamawa, extreme north and east are the regions with the highest prevalence rates.

Divide your audience into 4 groups and ask them to think about the following questions in 5 minutes (1 question per group):

- Why does child marriage affect girls more?
- Why is child marriage a traditional practice?
- Why is child marriage said to be a harmful practice?
- Could there be any positive effects of child marriage?

After 5 minutes, ask each group to give their answers. Write down the answers and provide a brief comment.

Tell parents that you will now dwell on the consequences of child marriage. You can use the following chart to demonstrate, or you can involve parents.



Physical and physiological level	Psychological, emotional and relational level	Social and cultural plan

3

BALANCING THE ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF PRACTICING CHILD MARRIAGE – ACTION POINTS FOR THE FUTURE

Tell parents that this session will be conducted in two stages: in the first phase, parents will be invited to play the game of scales or tug-of-war together and the second phase will be quieter with a moment of reflection and personal decision.

Phase 1: Game

Tell parents that you are going to weigh up the «benefits» of child marriage with the consequences in a scale to see which way the balance tips. Parents are expected to give both the pros and cons. Whenever an advantage or disadvantage is given, an object is put in the corresponding tray of the balance until all the advantages and disadvantages are explored. You can use objects that have the same weight such as ballpoint pens for example or discuss with your group to use different objects depending on the importance of the advantage or disadvantage advanced. This second approach takes much more time and you may face endless discussions to

choose the right object. We therefore recommend that you use objects of the same weight.

Instead of the scale, you can organize a tug-of-war game (ask parents if they feel comfortable with this game, if not, do not propose it. You can just line up the parents without pulling the rope).

Explain to parents that you will form two camps, that of advantages and that of disadvantages: for each new advantage, a parent will move to your left and for each disadvantage given, a parent will move to your right. Once all the pros and cons are stated, you can therefore organize the game of tug-of-war between the two groups.

Phase 2: reflection and personal decision

Take 5 minutes to discuss with parents the activity that just took place, what did they think of it and what do they learn from it?

Ask parents to take 5 minutes for their personal reflection and the decision



they make in relation to child marriage. If there are some who want to share their decisions, they can do so but do not take much time on it.

EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

1. What did you like most during the session?

2. What question would you have liked to ask but I didn't have the time or the opportunity?

Conclude the session by saying that all parents want the best for their children and sometimes parents can be wrong. But it is never late to review one's conduct and, in every situation, each parent must analyze what is good for his child in the light of his culture or tradition, the law, the needs of his child and his well-being today and in the future. Congratulate the parents on this session and don't forget about homework.

HOMEWORK

This week you have two assignments

1- In your discussion group, continue to exchange on what you have learned today and if possible about your personal decision regarding child marriage

2- Talk to a parent who is not involved in the training about what you have understood.

Remind parents that the next session is special because they have to come with their teenage children.



MODULE 10

ACCOMPANYING YOUR CHILD TO FACE THE CHALLENGES OF ADOLESCENCE

«If we have the courage to pursue them, all dreams come true.»

Walt Disney



GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Help participants develop skills, attitudes and practices necessary for caring supervision of their children during adolescence.

SPECIFICS OBJECTIVES

- Equip parents with the necessary skills to support their children in facing the challenges of adolescence;
- Equipping adolescents with life skills to better face the challenges of adolescence.

WORKING METHODOLOGY

- Presentations
- Questions and answers
- Sharing of experiences
- Case studies
- Evaluation of acquired knowledge.

PREPARATION OF THE SESSION

- Invite parents involved in the program
- Invite a few teenagers, ideally those whose parents are involved in the program
- Review the facilitator's guide before the session and prepare notes
- Prepare the necessary material (see module checklist).

EQUIPMENT REQUIRED

- ◇ Flip charts and markers
- ◇ Advice cards
- ◇ Posters
- ◇ Pamphlets



SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome speech and presentation of the agenda	10 min	Host
2	Séquence 1 : Brainstorming key concepts	10 min	Host
3	Séquence 2 : Fears and hopes	20 min	Host
4	Icebreaker	05 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Séquence 3 : Sexual life, reproductive health and gender-based violence	30 min	Host
6	Séquence 4 : Influence of social networks	20 min	Facilitator and participants
7	Séquence 5 : : Supporting adolescents in their life projects	30 min	Facilitator and participants
8	Evaluation of the session	05 min	Host
9	Homework	05 min	Host



INTRODUCTION OF THE SESSION

- Greetings
- Collect each other's opinions on the past session (review the work to be done at home if necessary), make a reminder of the past session.

Presentation of the topic : : In this session, we will learn how to accompany our children to face the challenges of adolescence. Adolescence is a period that separates childhood and adulthood, marked by sexual maturity. It is between 10 and 19 years old (WHO). Indeed, adolescents have specific needs and face many challenges: sexual and reproductive health management, use of alcohol, drugs and narcotics, harmful cultural practices (female genital mutilation, child marriage, ...), violence and abuse, including gender-based violence, influence of social networks, etc. We will look at how to help our children overcome these challenges.



SEQUENCE

1

BRAINSTORMING KEY CONCEPTS (10 MIN)

Ask participants how they define adolescence, sexuality, gender-based violence (GBV), challenges, social ills, etc. Take the point of view of some participants, make a summary and tell them that the following sequences will allow them to better understand the theme of the day.

2

FEARS AND HOPES (20 min)

Ask parents and teens to work as groups on fears and hopes. One group works on the fears and hopes of parents and the other on the fears and hopes of adolescents. After ten minutes of discussion, ask the representative of each group to report on the group's work.

Ask parents: What do you think of teens' fears? Are they justified? How do you plan to support your teenagers' hopes to become reality?

Ask teens: What do you think of parents' fears? Are they justified? What do you think of the hopes they have for you? What support do you expect from your parents to make your hopes come true?

3

SEXUAL LIFE, REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH AND GENDER-BASED VIOLENCE (30 min)

The subject of sexuality is a taboo in most households and communities. This is related to the fact that many parents think that talking about sexuality is just talking about sex.

To this end, tell participants that talking to children about sexuality is:

- Give them the necessary knowledge to take care of their bodies (example: how to wash private parts and underwear);

- Inform them about attitudes that could constitute a risk/danger to reproductive organs and thus reduce their chances of procreating, revoke abortions, early pregnancies and the risks to which they expose);

- Acquire the necessary skills for their sexual development and well-being (talk about contraceptive methods and menstrual hygiene management);

- Equip them on the know-how related to sexuality (modesty, respect ...).

Emphasize that discussion topics should be age-appropriate :

- For small children (03-10 years), show them how to do intimate grooming, how to wash underwear and draw their attention to suspicious attitudes (touching);

- For adolescents (11-16 years): discuss the transformations related to puberty and its implications, menstrual hygiene management).

How to ensure menstrual hygiene?

- 1- Use washable or non-washable sanitary napkins, preferably cotton;

- 2- Change them 02 to 03 times a day depending on the bleeding flow;

- 3- At bedtime, lie on your side and not on your stomach or back;

- 4- Wash used towels, pack them well and throw them in the trash.

Impact of early sexual intercourse and GBV on adolescent reproductive health

In view of the precociousness of adolescents / young with regard to sexual intercourse, the resurgence of child marriages in some communities, it is



relevant to question participants on the consequences that these behaviors could have on their health.

To do this, ask participants what they think about gender-based violence, including female circumcision and other harmful practices on the one hand, and early sex on the other.

Use the following table for clarification:

N°	Practices	Consequences	Comments
1	Early sexual intercourse	Early pregnancy, STIs, abortion, Obstetric fistula	Postponing the first sexual intercourse as late as possible has the advantage of promoting sexual and reproductive health (avoiding STIs, etc.) on the one hand and education on the other.
2	Early marriage (child marriage)	Low level of education, dropping out of school, early pregnancy, obstetric fistula, increased maternal and infant mortality	Preventing child marriage means promoting the realization of their rights and securing their future
3	Female genital mutilation	Physical and psychological trauma, STI.	Saying no to FGM is working for health and development
4	Breast ironing	Malformations, breast cancer and trauma	Combating this practice contributes to the promotion of the health and well-being of the child.
5	Sexual violence	Pregnancies, STIs, psychological distress, failures	

1. What would you do if your child is being abused?
2. How can we prevent our children from being subjected to violence?



Role of parents in managing puberty

Puberty is a delicate period of child development. During this period, the child who is in search of identity and reference points needs more supervision from parents, the family and the educational community.

Tell parents to listen, be patient and have dialogue. Above all, they must learn about the environment (attendance) and the interests of the child.

Before concluding the session, discuss with the participants the following question: what roles can parents play in helping adolescents manage puberty?

can parents play in helping adolescents manage puberty?

Invite parents to recall their teenage years for a few minutes: what were their fears? What information would they have liked to have had from their parents? Invite parents to write down these items to discuss with their own child in return.

4 INFLUENCE OF SOCIAL NETWORKS (20 mn)

Social networks are an essential element to take into account in the accompaniment of adolescents. Indeed, they play a role of social support, beneficial to the mental health of adolescents. They also contribute positively to relationships, with a simplification of communication with family and peers.

However, social networks can also have a temporary or lasting impact on young people. If the young person is not protected, he is exposed to the wrong people and sensitive content, not appropriate to his age, there is a great risk that he will be dangerous.

Ask participants:

- What do you know about social

media?

- Are you ready to buy your child a smartphone?
- Are social medias important to your child?

5 SUPPORTING TEENAGERS IN THEIR LIFE PROJECTS (30 mn)

A life project is a document that compiles what we want to be and what we will do to achieve it. It is a personal project defining the objectives to be achieved, taking into account the values and deep wishes of the person.

Ask participants divided into two groups (parents and teens):

To parents:

- Are you thinking about your child's future?
- Have you ever discussed the life project with your child? If so, how do you plan to help him carry out this project? If not, why?

To the adolescents:

- What are your life plans?
- What do you plan to do to achieve them?
- Have you talked about your life plans with your parents?

EVALUATION OF THE SESSION

Three (03) participants are invited to share in front of others their experiences on the themes developed. On the 1st, a parent talks about how he discusses sex education with his children. On 2ndnd, a girl shares a lived experience of gender-based violence. On the 3rd, a boy talks about his experience with social networks

Have a brief discussion with the group about:



- What did you like most about today's session?
- What did you like the least?
- Is there something you haven't learned or a topic that hasn't been discussed today that you'd like to come back to?

HOMEWORK

The facilitator gives participants instructions on homework:

1- You are welcome to spend time with your teens and ask them what they want from you as a parent. In turn, tell them what a parent expects from their teenage child. Discuss together the challenges the teen faces and explore ways to deal with them.

2- Take time to have a frank dialogue with your children, it will increase their confidence and self-esteem.

KEY MESSAGE

- Parents have an important role to play in helping their children better cope with the challenges of adolescence.
- A good knowledge by parents of the changes related to the adolescent period makes it possible to understand the expectations of their child and to provide him with adequate supervision necessary for his development.
- Taking into account the expectations of parents and adolescents builds mutual trust, self-esteem and helps adolescents develop their capacities to take charge of themselves and better manage the challenges they face.
- All parents and guardians, regardless of gender or culture, have the ability to establish a harmonious relationship with their child that facilitates his or her transition from childhood to adolescence.

- Strengthening parenting skills will allow them to improve the quality of the relationship with their child.

REFERENCES

- S. STEER : *jeunes et réseaux sociaux, des espaces de liberté sous multiple surveillance*, Ligue française des droits de l'Homme, 2017
- Mr. CLAES: *Parent-adolescent relations: a brief review of current work*, 2004
- David H. Demo, Stephen A. Small and Ritch C. Savin-Williams: *Family Relations and the Self-Esteem of Adolescents and Their Parents*, Article, 1987



END MODULE

A process of change, a commitment on honour



OBJECTIVE OF THE SESSION

Lead participants to engage in front of their community to be good parents, practice the techniques learned and promote good parenting in the family and community.

PREPARATION

Ensure that:

- Witnesses and hands-on activities are prepared
- Participants are prepared with their commitments
- The husbands/wives of the participants and their children will come
- The room is ready to welcome participants and guests (check the checklist of module materials).

SEQUENTIAL PROCESS

N°	Sequence	Duration	Speaker/Manager
1	Welcome and installation of participants Welcome and presentation of the agenda	05 min	Host
2	Séquence 1 : Introduction and presentation of the guests	15 min	All
3	Séquence 2 : Review of expectations and hopes/testimonials	15 min	Facilitator and participants
4	Intermède	05 min	Facilitator and participants
5	Séquence 3: Reminder of learning and sharing of experiences	30 min	Participants
6	Séquence 4 : Commitment on honour and presentation of certificates	20 min	Community Leaders
7	Festivity		All



Sequence

1

INTRODUCTION OF PARTICIPANTS AND PROMPTS (15 minutes)

1. Start the session with a dynamic: a song with all the children and guests. Applause. relationship with program participants. Be smiling, have fun and put everyone at ease!
2. Start the session with an introduction of yourself and the participants.

Ask children and guests to introduce themselves and explain their rela-

2

REVIEW OF EXPECTATIONS AND HOPES/TESTIMONIALS (15 min)

Take the time to recall the expectations and hopes of the participants at the beginning of the training. If necessary, display the conference papers on which they were recorded. Ask parents if their expectations have been met

Give yourself some time for ex-

changes and conclude the sequence by introducing the next sequence that will allow you to have more details on what the parents have learned over the past few months.

3

REMINDER OF LEARNING AND SHARING OF EXPERIENCES (30 min)

1. Ask parents to introduce the modules you have done together over the past few weeks and how they have been inspired by them.

2. Ask participants to testify about the different things they have learned and the actions they have begun within their families.

3. Ask husbands/wives/ children and other participants if they have any questions.

4. Explain that today is an important day for the community where adults will express the commitments they will

make to improve the situation of children.

This session can be done using different methodologies: sketches, poems, role-playing, etc.

Among the participants, find those who can testify to the things they have already done or changed through the positive parenting program. Make sure that witnesses give examples of each activity.



4

COMMITMENT ON HONOUR (15 min)

1. There can be individual commitments and specific promises if they want to.

2. Ask participants to stand in front of their families, children and community and read/say their pledge on honour aloud.

3. Give certificates to all participants who participated in all sessions.

4. Applause.

END: SESSION CLOSING STEPS

Thank the parents once again for completing the program and for the testimonials and activities organized. Take the time to explain the next steps (post-training follow-up in the community, commitment to action, post-training evaluation) and if the prospects for the next trainings are known, it is also an opportunity to specify them as well as the conditions to be fulfilled ...

ANNEXES

Appendix 1: Module completeness sheet

Appendix 2: Timecard/Attendance

Appendix 3: Guidelines for Parent Support Groups (PSGs)

Appendix 4: Home Visit Guide

Appendix 5: Session Scorecard



APPENDIX 1: MODULE COMPLETENESS SHEET

Facilitator fidelity or self-monitoring checklist

		Please circle YES or NO for each session/ activity step	
	Have you reviewed the homework activity with the participants? (e.g. ask participants if they have done their homework, ask participants to share their experiences)	YES	NO
	Did you follow the activities/exercises described in the guide?	YES	NO
	Session Completed, Sequence 1	YES	NO
	Session Completed, Sequence 2	YES	NO
	Session Completed, Sequence 3	YES	NO
	Session Completed, Sequence 4	YES	NO
	Session Completed, Sequence 5	YES	NO
	Session Completed, Sequence 6	YES	NO
	Have you explained clearly and precisely the information described in the manual, using appropriate language that is easy for participants to understand?	YES	NO
	Have you explained clearly and precisely the information described in the manual, using appropriate language that is easy for participants to understand?	YES	NO
	Were you warm, friendly, non-judgmental and respectful to the participants? (e.g. smile, address participants politely)	YES	NO
	Did you put participants in a position to ask questions and share their ideas? (for example, demand ask participants to share their views and experiences, ask if anyone has any questions)	YES	NO
	Did you show active listening when participants were talking? (e.g. eye contact with participants when they speak)	YES	NO
	Did you verify that participants understood and followed the sessions? (e.g. by asking open-ended questions)	YES	NO
	Avez-vous utilisé des histoires, des exemples personnels, des proverbes ou des dictons pour expliquer les idées pendant la session?	YES	NO



	Did you play games, sing songs or do other energizing and icebreaker activities during the session?	YES	NO
	Did you give and explain the assignments to the participants at the end of the session?	YES	NO
	Were you ready for the session? (e.g. flip charts prepared in advance, familiarization with topics and activities, prior writing of this session in your textbook)	YES	NO
PARTICIPATION DU GROUPE			
	Did all participants, men and women, actively participate in the session?	YES	NO
	Did participants ask questions during the session?	YES	NO
	Did participants share their thoughts, feelings or experiences during the session?	YES	NO
	Did the participants agree in the group?	YES	NO
	Do participants seem to understand and follow the topics of the session?	YES	NO
	Did participants participate in games, songs and other icebreaker activities during the session?	YES	NO

End of session evaluation for parents (attach to the loyalty form for each session)	Please write down what parents reported for each question.
What did the parents like most about this session?	
What questions would they have liked to have been able to ask but didn't have time to ask?	
What they found helpful About this session?	
Any other concerns or Feedback?	



APPENDIX 2: TIME/PRESENCE APPLICATION

Municipality of Locality

Group/village

Module.....

Session.....

Date.....

	Parents' first and last names	Sex	Start	End
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				
15				
16				
17				
18				
19				
20				



ANNEXE 3 : APPENDIX 3: GUIDELINES FOR PARENT SUPPORT GROUPS (PSG)

As part of the Positive Parenting program, you will encourage parents to form small support groups (4-6 parents per group) to support each other in learning parenting skills.

At the end of session 1 (set aside about 15 minutes for this). Help parents decide how they will split up in their groups. Some suggestions:

1. Group them according to geographical location; That way it would be easier for them to get together.
2. Group them according to the age of their children.
3. Or just let them decide if they have any ideas on how to regroup.

Then explain the purpose of the support groups:

1. Parent support groups will help you reinforce your learning of this module as you will be able to talk to others about skills and even practice.
2. Parent support groups need to be positive and supportive. We want you to celebrate and encourage each other.
3. You can also talk about problems you may encounter at home with your children or another family member and find solutions together.
4. This program will end after 10 weeks and we want you to meet and support each other. Being a parent is hard work!



APPENDIX 4: HOME VISIT GUIDE

Name of group leader making the home visit.....

Name of the head of the family

Date :

Attendees:.....

This coaching session aims to help parents implement the positive parenting skills they are learning in your group. You will encourage the parents, congratulate them on the progress they are making, and help them solve the problems you are going to address.

Guide and tips for a successful coaching session

1. At the end of the third session in your parent group, remind parents that the in-home coaching sessions will begin and you will arrange to visit them all in their homes, to provide them with additional support in implementing these new parenting skills.
2. Schedule the home visit in advance with the family at a convenient time.
3. Make sure their children will be at home as you want to see how they use the achievements of homeschooling with their children.
4. Ask if the parent or guardian has anything specific they would like to talk about while you're there and if so, address it first.
5. Then ask the parent to show you how they are implementing their new skills by playing with, feeding, or doing another activity they choose with their child. Bring something for both parent and child to play with (toys for children aged 0-5 are the target of the project) in case the parent has nothing at home. You can also plan to help create a toy or show them how to use something they have at home as a toy to play with their child.
6. When they're done playing or interacting, praise them for all the effort they've put into using positive parenting skills and kindly offer them some suggestions for talking, looking, or smiling at their child if you haven't seen them do some of these things.
7. Once you have finished coaching parents in their positive interactions and collected any questions or concerns they have, ask the parents the following questions and then complete the home visiting activities questionnaire below:



Questions for parents

1. How often are you able to spend positive time with your child(ren)? What kind of things do you do with them?

.....
.....
.....

2. When your children behave well, do you use words of encouragement? What words do you use?

.....
.....
.....

3. What other positive parenting techniques have we talked about in our sessions that you use? How do you use them? How often?

.....
.....
.....

4. Ask parents how they are coping with homework and whether they have had a chance to discuss it with their support group.

.....
.....
.....

Thank the parents for allowing you to visit their home!

NOTE: Please retain all home coaching forms to facilitate data collection at the end of the intervention.



APPENDIX 5: FINAL EVALUATION SHEET OF A TRAINING SESSION

CRITERIA	RATING SCALE			
	Unsatisfactory(1)	Unsatisfactory(2)	Satisfactory(3)	Very satisfactory(4)
Achievement of training objectives				
Personal expectations met				
Relevance of training				
Use of training materials (manual, poster, advice card, etc.)				
Training methodology (methods and techniques)				
Medium organization of training (training room, training mat)				
Animators (mastery of themes, communication)				



Have your questions been answered?				
Sharing experience				
During training sessions				

What do you think about the duration of the training?

Too long /___/ Too short /___/ Ideal duration /___/

What topics covered during this training will be most useful for you ?

.....

.....

What topics would you have liked to have more information about or would you have preferred to spend more time?

.....

.....

Other comments or suggestions

.....

.....

THANK YOU FOR YOUR PARTICIPATION!